MUST-SCORE FACTS

Economy

Consolidated Must-Score Facts and must-score drill cards for every chapter.

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Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts

1. National Income Aggregates & Macroeconomic Formulas

Concept / Metric	Formula / Technical Definition	Key Exam Traps & Prelims Triggers
GDP at Market Price	GDP_{MP} = C + I + G + (X - M)	Total market value of all final goods & services produced **within the domestic territory** in 1 year. Foreigners earning in India included; Indians earning abroad excluded.
GNP at Market Price	GNP_{MP} = GDP_{MP} + NFIA	Measures income earned by **nationals/citizens** regardless of geographical location. NFIA = Net Factor Income from Abroad (Factor income from abroad - Factor income paid abroad).
NNP at Market Price	NNP_{MP} = GNP_{MP} - \text{Depreciation}	Deducts consumption of fixed capital (depreciation). **Depreciation is also called Capital Consumption Allowance**.
NNP at Factor Cost (National Income)	NNP_{FC} = NNP_{MP} - \text{Net Indirect Taxes (NIT)}	Traditional official definition of **National Income**. Net Indirect Taxes (NIT) = Indirect Taxes - Subsidies.
Gross Value Added (GVA)	GVA_{Basic} = GVA_{Factor\ Cost} + \text{Production Taxes} - \text{Production Subsidies}	Since 2015, India measures headline GDP as: **GDP_{MP} = GVA_{Basic} + \text{Product Taxes} - \text{Product Subsidies}**. Base year changed to **2011–12**.
Personal Disposable Income (PDI)	PDI = \text{Personal Income} - \text{Direct Taxes} - \text{Miscellaneous Fees/Fines}	Actual income available to households for consumption expenditure and savings.
Real GDP vs Nominal GDP	\text{Real GDP} = \frac{\text{Nominal GDP}}{\text{GDP Deflator}} \times 100	Real GDP is calculated at **constant base year prices** (eliminates inflation impact). Nominal GDP is at current prices.
GDP Deflator	\frac{\text{Nominal GDP}}{\text{Real GDP}} \times 100	Most comprehensive measure of inflation in an economy because it covers **all goods and services** produced, unlike CPI/WPI which use a fixed basket.

> **Examiner Trap:** Transfer payments (old age pensions, unemployment allowance, student scholarships) are **excluded** from National Income because no corresponding production of goods or services occurs. Second-hand goods sales are also excluded (only broker commission is included).

2. Five-Year Plans (FYP) & NITI Aayog Master Matrix

Plan & Duration	Model / Architect	Core Objective / Strategy	Key Milestones & Exam Triggers
1st FYP (1951–56)	**Harrod-Domar Model**	Agriculture, irrigation, price stability	Bhakra-Nangal, Hirakud, Damodar Valley dams launched; Target 2.1%, Achieved 3.6%.
2nd FYP (1956–61)	**P.C. Mahalanobis Model**	Rapid industrialisation, Heavy & Basic Industries	Steel plants at **Bhilai** (USSR), **Rourkela** (Germany), **Durgapur** (UK); Industrial Policy Resolution 1956.
3rd FYP (1961–66)	John Sandy & Sukhamoy Chakravarty	Self-reliant & self-generating economy	**Bokaro Steel Plant** (1964, USSR), FCI & CACP set up (1965). Plan failed due to 1962 China War, 1965 Pak War, 1965–66 Severe Drought.
Plan Holiday (1966–69)	Three Annual Plans	Green Revolution rollout	Devaluation of Indian Rupee (1966); High-Yielding Varieties (HYV) seeds introduced.
4th FYP (1969–74)	D.R. Gadgil Formula	Growth with stability & progressive self-reliance	**14 Major Commercial Banks Nationalised** (19 July 1969); Pokhran-I Nuclear Test (*Smiling Buddha*, 1974); 1971 Indo-Pak War.

Plan & Duration	Model / Architect	Core Objective / Strategy	Key Milestones & Exam Triggers
5th FYP (1974–79)	D.P. Dhar Model	**Garibi Hatao** (Poverty Eradication) & Self-reliance	**20-Point Programme** (1975); Minimum Needs Programme (MNP); Terminated 1 year early in 1978 by Janata Govt.
Rolling Plan (1978–80)	Gunnar Myrdal concept	Annual revisions without fixed 5-year lock	Introduced by Janata Govt (Morarji Desai); ended when Congress returned in 1980.
6th FYP (1980–85)	Investment & Modernisation	Poverty eradication, economic & tech self-reliance	**NABARD established** (12 July 1982, Shivaraman Committee); **EXIM Bank** (1982); **6 more banks nationalised** (1980).
7th FYP (1985–90)	Pranab Mukherjee / Lakdawala	Food, Work & Productivity	Speed Post (1986); SEBI formed (1988); Jawahar Rozgar Yojana (JRY, 1989).
Annual Plans (1990–92)	Balance of Payments Crisis	Structural reforms & crisis stabilization	**LPG Reforms (1991)**: Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation under P.V. Narasimha Rao & Dr. Manmohan Singh.
8th FYP (1992–97)	John W. Miller Model	Human Resource Development (employment, education)	India joined **WTO** (1 Jan 1995); National Stock Exchange (NSE) operationalised.
9th FYP (1997–2002)	Social Justice & Equality	Growth with Social Justice and Equity	50 years of Indian Independence; Asian Financial Crisis backdrop.
10th FYP (2002–07)	Target 8% GDP Growth	Doubling per capita income in 10 years, reduce poverty by 5%	National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (**NREGA**, 2005); Bharat Nirman.
11th FYP (2007–12)	C. Rangarajan / Montek Singh	**Faster and More Inclusive Growth**	Right to Education (RTE Act, 2009); National Rural Livelihoods Mission (NRLM).
12th FYP (2012–17)	Final Five-Year Plan	**Faster, More Inclusive and Sustainable Growth**	Terminated; replaced by NITI Aayog 15-Year Vision, 7-Year Strategy & 3-Year Action Agenda.

> **NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India):** Formed on **1 January 2015** replacing the Planning Commission (15 March 1950). Non-constitutional, non-statutory extra-constitutional think tank. Chairperson: **Prime Minister**. Governing Council comprises all State Chief Ministers, UT Lt Governors/CMs. Operates on **Bottom-Up** approach and **Cooperative Federalism** (unlike top-down Planning Commission).

3. Monetary Policy, RBI Instruments & Money Supply Aggregates

A. RBI Monetary Policy Instruments Master Table

Instrument	Nature / Category	Operational Mechanism & Definition
Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)	Quantitative / Direct	Percentage of Net Demand and Time Liabilities (NDTL) commercial banks **must keep with RBI in cash**. No interest paid by RBI on CRR. Governed by RBI Act, 1934 (Sec 42).
Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)	Quantitative / Direct	Percentage of NDTL commercial banks **must maintain with themselves** in approved liquid assets (Cash, Gold, Govt Securities). Governed by Banking Regulation Act, 1949 (Sec 24).
Repo Rate	Quantitative / Indirect	Rate at which RBI lends short-term money to commercial banks against **government securities as collateral** (repurchase agreement). Primary policy rate.
Reverse Repo Rate	Quantitative / Indirect	Rate at which RBI borrows short-term funds from commercial banks against government securities.

Instrument	Nature / Category	Operational Mechanism & Definition
Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)	Quantitative / Liquidity	Introduced in April 2022 under amended RBI Act (Sec 17). Allows RBI to absorb excess liquidity from commercial banks **without providing any collateral (G-Secs)**. Replaced Reverse Repo as floor of LAF corridor.
Marginal Standing Facility (MSF)	Quantitative / Liquidity	Penal rate at which scheduled commercial banks can borrow overnight funds from RBI by dipping into their SLR quota (up to prescribed limit). Ceiling of LAF corridor.
Bank Rate	Quantitative / Long-term	Rate at which RBI buys or rediscounts bills of exchange or commercial papers; benchmark for penal interest rates on non-compliance with reserve requirements.
Open Market Operations (OMO)	Quantitative / Market	Outright purchase and sale of Government Securities (G-Secs) by RBI in open market to inject or absorb durable liquidity.
Moral Suasion, Credit Rationing, Margin Requirements	Qualitative / Selective	Directives to banks to channel credit to specific priority sectors, control speculative borrowing, and regulate loan-to-value (LTV) ratios.

B. Money Supply Measures (Monetary Aggregates)

- **Reserve Money (M_0 / High Powered Money):** Currency in Circulation + Bankers' deposits with RBI + 'Other' deposits with RBI.
- **Narrow Money (M_1):** Currency with Public + Demand Deposits with Banking System (Current & Savings Account - CASA) + 'Other' deposits with RBI. *(Most liquid aggregate).*
- **M_2:** M_1 + Post Office Savings Bank deposits.
- **Broad Money (M_3):** M_1 + Time Deposits (Fixed/Recurring Deposits) with the banking system. *(Most commonly used indicator of money supply in India).*
- **M_4:** M_3 + All deposits with Post Office Savings Organisation (excluding National Savings Certificates / NSC).
- **Liquidity Hierarchy:** M_1 > M_2 > M_3 > M_4.

C. Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)

- Statutory body constituted under **Section 45ZB of RBI Act, 1934** (amended by Finance Act, 2016).
- **6 Members:** 3 from RBI (RBI Governor as ex-officio Chairperson, Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy, 1 RBI officer) + 3 external members appointed by Central Government.
- **Inflation Target:** Central Govt in consultation with RBI sets retail inflation target (CPI headline) at **4% with a tolerance band of \pm 2\%** (i.e., 2% to 6%).
- Meets at least **4 times a year**. Quorum is 4 members. Each member has 1 vote; RBI Governor has a **casting vote** in case of a tie.

4. Inflation Indices: CPI vs WPI Master Comparison

Parameter	Wholesale Price Index (WPI)	Consumer Price Index (CPI - Combined)
Publishing Authority	Office of Economic Adviser (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce & Industry	National Statistical Office (NSO), Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)
Base Year	**2011–12** (Revised from 2004–05 in 2017)	**2012**
Official Headline Anchor	Used for wholesale trade transactions	**Official headline anchor for RBI Monetary Policy** (since Urjit Patel Committee, 2014)
Services Included?	**NO services included** (Goods only)	**YES, Services are included** (Housing, Transport, Education, Medical, etc.)
Number of Commodities	**697 items**	448 items (Rural), 460 items (Urban)

Parameter	Wholesale Price Index (WPI)	Consumer Price Index (CPI - Combined)
Highest Weight Group	**Manufactured Products (64.23%)** > Primary Articles (22.62%) > Fuel & Power (13.15%)	**Food and Beverages (45.86%)** > Misc/Services (28.32%) > Housing (10.07%)
Price Point Measured	First point of bulk commercial transaction	Retail consumer purchase point

5. Public Finance, Deficits & Finance Commission

A. Deficit Formulas Master Sheet

1. **Fiscal Deficit (FD):** \text{Total Expenditure} - \text{Total Receipts (excluding borrowings)}. It represents the total borrowing requirements of the government from all sources in that year.
2. **Revenue Deficit (RD):** \text{Revenue Expenditure} - \text{Revenue Receipts}. Indicates that the government is borrowing to finance day-to-day consumption rather than capital asset creation.
3. **Effective Revenue Deficit (ERD):** \text{Revenue Deficit} - \text{Grants for creation of capital assets}. Introduced in Union Budget 2011–12.
4. **Primary Deficit (PD):** \text{Fiscal Deficit} - \text{Interest Payments}. Measures the current year's fiscal stance excluding the burden of past accumulated debt interest.

B. Finance Commission (Article 280) Master Matrix

- Quasi-judicial body constituted by the **President every 5 years** under Article 280.
- Recommends devolution of net proceeds of taxes between Union and States (Vertical devolution) and allocation among States (Horizontal devolution).
- **1st FC:** K.C. Neogy (1951)
- **13th FC:** Dr. Vijay Kelkar (recommending GST framework)
- **14th FC:** Dr. Y.V. Reddy (increased States' share sharply from 32% to **42%**)
- **15th FC: N.K. Singh** (2020–26): Devolution share set at **41%** (1% adjusted for newly created UTs of J&K and Ladakh). Criteria weights: Income Distance (45%), Population 2011 (15%), Area (15%), Forest & Ecology (10%), Demographic Performance (12.5%), Tax Effort (2.5%).
- **16th FC:** Constituted on 31 Dec 2023 under chairmanship of **Dr. Arvind Panagariya** (former Vice Chairman of NITI Aayog).

6. Banking & Financial Sector Milestones

- **1935 (1 April):** RBI established on recommendations of **Hilton Young Commission (1926)** under RBI Act, 1934. Initial capital ₹5 crore; nationalised on **1 January 1949**.
- **1955:** Imperial Bank of India (formed in 1921 by amalgamating Presidency Banks of Bengal, Bombay, Madras) nationalised and renamed **State Bank of India (SBI)** on recommendation of All India Rural Credit Survey Committee (AD Gorwala).
- **1969 (19 July): 14 Major Commercial Banks** (with deposits \ge ₹50 crore) nationalised by Indira Gandhi Govt via Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Ordinance.
- **1975 (2 October):** First Regional Rural Bank (**Prathama Bank**, Moradabad, UP) established on recommendations of **M. Narasimham Working Group**.
- **1980 (15 April): 6 More Commercial Banks** (with deposits \ge ₹200 crore) nationalised.
- **1982 (12 July): NABARD** established under NABARD Act, 1981 on recommendation of **B. Sivaraman Committee**.
- **1988:** SEBI set up as non-statutory body; granted statutory powers via **SEBI Act, 1992** on 30 January 1992.

- **Priority Sector Lending (PSL) Targets:** Total PSL target for Domestic Scheduled Commercial Banks and Foreign Banks with \ge 20 branches is **40% of Adjusted Net Bank Credit (ANBC)**. Sub-targets: Agriculture (18%, within which 10% for Small & Marginal Farmers), Micro Enterprises (7.5%), Weaker Sections (12%). For Regional Rural Banks (RRBs) and Small Finance Banks (SFBs), total PSL target is **75% of ANBC**.

7. Agricultural Revolutions, Schemes & MSP

A. Colour Revolutions in Indian Agriculture

Colour Revolution	Associated Sector / Commodity	Pioneer / Father in India
Green Revolution	Food Grains (Wheat & Rice, HYV seeds)	**M.S. Swaminathan** (Norman Borlaug globally)
White Revolution (Operation Flood)	Milk & Dairy Development (1970)	**Dr. Verghese Kurien** (Amul / NDDB Anand)
Blue Revolution	Fisheries & Aquaculture	Dr. Hiralal Chaudhuri & Dr. Arun Krishnan
Yellow Revolution	Oilseeds (Mustard, Sunflower, Soyabean)	Sam Pitroda
Golden Revolution	Horticulture, Honey, Fruits	Nirpakh Tutej
Golden Fibre Revolution	**Jute** production	-
Silver Revolution	Eggs & Poultry	Indira Gandhi
Silver Fibre Revolution	**Cotton** production	-
Pink Revolution	Onion, Pharmaceuticals, Prawn	Durgesh Patel
Red Revolution	Meat & Tomato production	Vishal Tewari
Round Revolution	**Potato** production	-
Grey Revolution	Fertilizers	-
Brown Revolution	Leather, Non-conventional energy, Cocoa	-
Rainbow Revolution	Integrated development of all agri sectors	Announced in Agri Policy 2000

B. Minimum Support Price (MSP) Mechanism

- Announced by Central Government on recommendations of **CACP (Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices)** before sowing season.
- Covers **22 mandated crops** + Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) for **Sugarcane**:
- 7 Cereals (Paddy, Wheat, Maize, Jowar, Bajra, Ragi, Barley)
- 5 Pulses (Gram, Arhar/Tur, Moong, Urad, Masur)
- 8 Oilseeds (Groundnut, Rapeseed/Mustard, Soyabean, Sesamum, Sunflower, Safflower, Nigerseed, Copra)
- Raw Cotton, Raw Jute, De-husked Coconut
- **Cost Concepts used by CACP:**
- A2: Direct paid-out costs on seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, hired labour, fuel, irrigation.
- A2 + FL: A2 + Imputed value of unpaid family labour.
- C2: Comprehensive cost (A2 + FL + rental value of owned land + interest on owned capital assets).
- Central Govt formula since Union Budget 2018–19: MSP set at **at least 1.5 times (150\%) of A2 + FL**.

8. Poverty Estimation Committees & Multidimensional Poverty

Committee & Year	Consumption Basket / Criteria Used	Poverty Line Benchmark (Monthly / Daily)
Y.K. Alagh (1979)	Minimum Nutritional Calorie intake	**2,400 kcal/day** in Rural areas; **2,100 kcal/day** in Urban areas.

Committee & Year	Consumption Basket / Criteria Used	Poverty Line Benchmark (Monthly / Daily)
D.T. Lakdawala (1993)	Calorie norms linked with state-specific price indices (CPI-AL for rural, CPI-IW for urban)	State-specific poverty lines; rejected uniform national basket.
Suresh Tendulkar (2009)	Shifted from calories to mixed reference basket including **Health, Education, Clothing, Footwear**	Set per capita daily consumption at **₹27.2 in rural** and **₹33.3 in urban** areas (₹816/month rural, ₹1000/month urban at 2011–12 prices). National poverty rate: **21.9%** (2011–12).
C. Rangarajan (2014)	Independent nutritional norm (2,155 kcal rural, 2,090 kcal urban + protein/fat) + non-food expenses	Set per capita daily consumption at **₹32 in rural** and **₹47 in urban** areas (₹972/month rural, ₹1407/month urban). National poverty rate: **29.5%** (2011–12).

Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) by NITI Aayog:
Follows Alkire-Foster methodology. **3 Dimensions and 12 Indicators** (each dimension weighted equally at 1/3): 1. **Health (1/3):** Nutrition (1/6), Child & Adolescent Mortality (1/12), Maternal Health (1/12). 2. **Education (1/3):** Years of Schooling (1/6), School Attendance (1/6). 3. **Standard of Living (1/3):** Cooking Fuel, Sanitation, Drinking Water, Electricity, Housing, Assets, Bank Account (each 1/21).

9. International Financial Institutions & Global Economic Reports

Institution / Group	Established	Headquarters	Key Publications / Reports
International Monetary Fund (IMF)	1944 (Bretton Woods)	**Washington D.C.**	**World Economic Outlook (WEO)**, **Global Financial Stability Report (GFSR)**, Fiscal Monitor
World Bank (IBRD + IDA)	1944 (Bretton Woods)	**Washington D.C.**	**Global Economic Prospects (GEP)**, World Development Report (WDR)
World Economic Forum (WEF)	1971 (Klaus Schwab)	**Cologny/Geneva (Switzerland)**	**Global Competitiveness Report**, **Global Gender Gap Report**, Global Risks Report, Energy Transition Index
World Trade Organisation (WTO)	1 Jan 1995 (Marrakesh)	**Geneva (Switzerland)**	World Trade Report
Asian Development Bank (ADB)	1966	**Mandaluyong, Manila (Philippines)**	Asian Development Outlook (ADO)
Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)	2016	**Beijing (China)**	China largest shareholder, India 2nd largest shareholder
New Development Bank (NDB / BRICS Bank)	2014 (Fortaleza)	**Shanghai (China)**	First President: K.V. Kamath (India)
UNDP	1965	**New York (USA)**	**Human Development Report (HDR)** — HDI, IHDI, GII, MPI

Special Drawing Rights (SDR - Paper Gold): International reserve asset created by the IMF in 1969. The SDR basket includes **5 currencies**: US Dollar, Euro, Chinese Renminbi (Yuan - added in 2016), Japanese Yen, and British Pound Sterling.

Topic 1 — Indian Economy: Basics, Evolution and Planning

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. India is classified as a **mixed economy**, where both the public and private sectors coexist, operate simultaneously, and complement each other under state regulation. Following the **1991 economic reforms**, market orientation expanded substantially while public enterprises retained strategic presence.
2. Standard development economics categorizes India as a **developing or underdeveloped economy** on structural grounds (historically low per capita income, agrarian workforce concentration, disguised unemployment, and capital scarcity), despite possessing a large aggregate GDP.
3. **Adam Smith** is universally acclaimed as the **"Father of Economics"** (author of *The Wealth of Nations*, 1776, outlining the market mechanism and division of labour). In contrast, **John Maynard Keynes (J.M. Keynes)** is recognized as the father of modern **macroeconomics** (*The General Theory of Employment, Interest and Money*, 1936), advocating government intervention during recessions.
4. Structurally, India is defined as a **labour-surplus economy** (possessing an abundant workforce relative to capital availability at comparatively low wages), rather than a capital-surplus or trade-surplus nation.
5. Primary structural indicators of an underdeveloped economy include **low per capita income**, **low rate of capital formation**, high dependence on primary agriculture, and technological dualism. Conversely, a **low dependency ratio** and a **tertiary-dominated employment structure** characterize advanced, developed economies.
6. An economic activity involves production, exchange, or service delivery for monetary consideration (such as farming, industry, transport, or professional services). **Voluntary social service** is performed without profit or income motives and is categorized as a non-economic activity.
7. **Economic growth** represents a quantitative, measurable expansion in an economy's real output of goods and services over time. The most dependable indicator of sustained economic growth is a continuous rise in **real per capita income**.
8. **Economic development** is a broader, multi-dimensional qualitative concept that encompasses improvements in standard of living, reduction in poverty and inequality, access to healthcare and education, and overall enhancement in institutional welfare.
9. An increase in **per capita income is necessary but not sufficient** for economic development. A rise in real national income fails to represent development if levels of poverty, unemployment, and socio-economic deprivation deteriorate simultaneously.
10. The **"Hindu rate of growth"**, a concept formulated by renowned economist **Prof. Raj Krishna** in 1978, describes the stagnant annual growth rate of the Indian economy (averaging ~**3.5%** for GDP and ~1.3% for per capita income) between the 1950s and early 1980s, reflecting rigid bureaucratic controls rather than cultural characteristics.
11. **Gross Domestic Product (GDP)** measures the total market value of all **final** goods and services produced within the geographic boundaries (domestic territory) of a country during a specified financial year.
12. **Gross National Product (GNP / GNI)** incorporates cross-border earnings by residents, defined as GDP adjusted for **Net Factor Income from Abroad (NFIA)**: **GNP = GDP + NFIA**.
13. **Net Domestic Product (NDP)** is calculated by deducting depreciation (consumption of fixed capital) from GDP: **NDP = GDP − Depreciation**. Similarly, **Net National Product (NNP)** equals **GNP − Depreciation**.
14. In classical Indian national accounts methodology, **National Income (NI)** is formally defined as **Net National Product at factor cost (NNP_FC)**: **NNP_FC = NNP_MP − Indirect Taxes + Subsidies**.
15. **Real GDP** evaluates output using constant (base-year) prices, thereby eliminating the distorting impact of inflation. In contrast, **Nominal GDP** is computed using **current prevailing market prices**.
16. The **base year** designates the reference benchmark period whose prices are utilized to calculate constant-price real economic series. Effective **February 2026**, MoSPI revised the National Accounts base year to **2022–23** (replacing the former **2011–12** base year).

17. The three standard macroeconomic methods for estimating national income are the **Production (Value Added) Method**, the **Income Method**, and the **Expenditure Method**. Methods such as the "diminishing-cost method" are fictitious distractors not recognized in national accounting.
18. The value of intermediate consumption is excluded from GDP compilation to prevent the error of **double counting**; only final goods and services (or net value added at each productive stage) are included.
19. In India, national income statistics are compiled and released by the **National Statistical Office (NSO)** under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI). The NSO was established in **2019** through the amalgamation of the Central Statistics Office (**CSO**) and the National Sample Survey Office (**NSSO**).
20. The first historical estimate of India's national income was made by **Dadabhai Naoroji** in *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (for 1867–68, estimating per capita income at approximately **₹20**). The first **scientific** estimate was produced by **Dr. V.K.R.V. Rao** (1931–32). In 1949, the Government of India appointed the **National Income Committee** chaired by **Prof. P.C. Mahalanobis** (with D.R. Gadgil and V.K.R.V. Rao as members).
21. A **high Capital–Output Ratio (COR)** or Incremental Capital–Output Ratio (ICOR) signifies capital inefficiency, explaining why an economy may experience sluggish GDP expansion despite sustaining high gross domestic savings. Rapid **population growth** additionally suppresses per capita income growth.
22. The **household sector** constitutes the dominant contributor to India's gross domestic savings. Within household savings, **physical assets** (real estate, gold, durables) have historically accounted for a larger share than financial assets (bank deposits, currency, equities).
23. In terms of aggregate State Domestic Product (GSDP), **Maharashtra** is the largest state economy in India. Conversely, **Bihar** records the lowest per capita income among major states, while **Goa** and **Sikkim** lead the country in per capita income.
24. Under the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, **"Economic and Social Planning"** is placed in the **Concurrent List (List III, Entry 20)**, establishing concurrent legislative and executive jurisdiction for both Union and State Governments.
25. The **Planning Commission** was instituted on **15 March 1950** by a **Union Cabinet Resolution**. It was an **extra-constitutional, non-statutory**, advisory body that functioned as the central planner of resource allocation until its dissolution.
26. **NITI Aayog** (National Institution for Transforming India) superseded the Planning Commission on **1 January 2015** via an executive resolution of the Union Cabinet. It operates as the premier policy think tank of the Government of India without executive allocation powers over plan funds.
27. The **Prime Minister of India** serves as the ex-officio **Chairperson** of NITI Aayog. Day-to-day administrative and executive leadership is vested in a full-time **Vice-Chairperson** holding Cabinet Minister rank.
28. The inaugural Vice-Chairperson of NITI Aayog was **Prof. Arvind Panagariya** (January 2015 – August 2017). The first Chief Executive Officer (CEO) was **Sindhushree Khullar**, subsequently followed by Amitabh Kant and **B.V.R. Subrahmanyam**.
29. NITI Aayog is mandated to foster **cooperative federalism** (by providing structured institutional participation to States) and **competitive federalism** (by ranking State performances on developmental indices). Unlike the Planning Commission, it does **not allocate financial grants or plan funds**.
30. The **Governing Council** of NITI Aayog comprises the Prime Minister, Chief Ministers of all States and Union Territories with legislative assemblies (Delhi, Puducherry, Jammu & Kashmir), and Lieutenant Governors of other Union Territories. **State Governors are not members** of the Governing Council.
31. **NITI Aayog** functions as the designated **nodal institution** for coordinating, tracking, and implementing the United Nations **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** across Indian States and Union Territories.
32. The **Development Monitoring and Evaluation Office (DMEO)** was established on **18 September 2015** as an attached office of NITI Aayog, formed by merging the Programme Evaluation Organisation (**PEO**) and the Independent Evaluation Office (**IEO**).
33. The **National Development Council (NDC)** was formed on **6 August 1952** under the chairmanship of the Prime Minister to coordinate development policy between the Centre and States.

34. The primary constitutional function of the NDC was the **formal approval and review of Five-Year Plans**. Although its functions have been largely subsumed by NITI Aayog's Governing Council, no official government notification has formally abolished the council.
35. The **Finance Commission** is a **constitutional body (Article 280)** appointed by the President every five years to recommend statutory tax devolution and grants-in-aid. In contrast, the former Planning Commission was a non-constitutional body that determined discretionary capital and developmental plan assistance.
36. India's Five-Year Plans spanned from the **First Plan (1951–56)** to the **Twelfth Plan (2012–17)**. The 12th Plan was the final formal Five-Year Plan in Indian history before the adoption of NITI Aayog's 15-year Vision, 7-year Strategy, and 3-year Action Agenda.
37. The **First Five-Year Plan (1951–56)** was built on the **Harrod–Domar growth model** and prioritized agriculture, river valley irrigation projects, and energy infrastructure to mitigate post-Independence food shortages. Planned economic development formally commenced on **1 April 1951**.
38. The **Second Five-Year Plan (1956–61)** was formulated by **Prof. P.C. Mahalanobis** and prioritized heavy basic industries, public sector expansion, and the establishment of a **"Socialistic Pattern of Society"** under the Industrial Policy Resolution (IPR) of 1956.
39. The period from **1966 to 1969** witnessed a **Plan Holiday**, during which three consecutive Annual Plans were formulated due to macroeconomic dislocations caused by the Indo-Pak War (1965), consecutive monsoon droughts, and foreign exchange crises.
40. The **Fifth Five-Year Plan (1974–79)** established the twin objectives of **poverty alleviation ("Garibi Hatao")** and the attainment of **economic self-reliance** (achieving zero net foreign concessional aid). The plan was terminated a year early in 1978 by the Janata Party administration.
41. The **Eleventh Five-Year Plan (2007–12)** adopted the core theme **"Towards Faster and More Inclusive Growth"**, setting an aggregate GDP target of **9%**, an agricultural growth target of **4%**, and an industrial growth target of **10–10.5%**.
42. The **Twelfth Five-Year Plan (2012–17)** carried the vision **"Faster, More Inclusive and Sustainable Growth"**. The National Development Council approved an average GDP growth target of **8%** and prioritized environmental sustainability and massive infrastructure investment estimated at **USD 1 trillion**.
43. **Imperative (Command) Planning** completely replaces market mechanisms with state central allocation and mandatory directives (as in the former USSR). In contrast, **Indicative Planning** guides, incentivizes, and supplements market forces—the framework adopted by India during its post-1991 mixed economy evolution.
44. The landmark **LPG Reforms (1991)**—Liberalisation, Privatisation, and Globalisation—were introduced under Prime Minister **P.V. Narasimha Rao** and Finance Minister **Dr. Manmohan Singh** to resolve a severe Balance of Payments (BoP) foreign exchange crisis.
45. An initial **first phase of deregulation and industrial delicensing** was initiated earlier in the mid-1980s under Prime Minister **Rajiv Gandhi**. However, comprehensive, systemic macroeconomic structural adjustment dates from July 1991.
46. The **Rolling Plan (1978–80)** was introduced by the Janata Party government under Morarji Desai, based on development concepts articulated by Swedish Nobel laureate **Gunnar Myrdal** in *Asian Drama*, wherein annual performance was reviewed and targets rolled forward continuously.
47. The pre-Independence **National Planning Committee (1938)** was established by Indian National Congress President **Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose**, with **Jawaharlal Nehru** serving as its Chairman.
48. The **Bombay Plan (1944)** (*A Plan of Economic Development for India*) was drafted by leading private industrialists, including **J.R.D. Tata, G.D. Birla, Lala Shri Ram, Kasturbhai Lalbhai, A.D. Shroff, Purshottamdas Thakurdas, and John Mathai**. Prominent later figures like Dhirubhai Ambani were **not** associated with this document.
49. The **Gandhian Plan (1944)**, authored by **Sriman Narayan Agarwal**, advocated economic decentralization, cottage crafts, rural self-sufficiency, and village swaraj. Mahatma Gandhi philosophically opposed centralized, top-down bureaucratic industrial planning.
50. The official acronym **NITI** expands to the **National Institution for Transforming India**.

📋 Must-Score Drill — Plans, Institutions and Core Milestones

Historical Item or Institution	Core Distinction / Key Milestone
Economic & Social Planning	Concurrent List (List III, Entry 20) under Seventh Schedule
Planning Commission Establishment	Cabinet Resolution on 15 March 1950; advisory, non-constitutional, non-statutory
Ashok Chandra Characterization	Described the Planning Commission as India's "Economic Cabinet"
National Development Council (NDC)	Constituted 6 August 1952; chaired by Prime Minister; apex body for Five-Year Plan approval
NITI Aayog Launch	1 January 2015 by Union Cabinet Resolution; policy think tank replacing Planning Commission
First NITI Vice-Chair & CEO	Arvind Panagariya (Vice-Chair) and Sindhushree Khullar (CEO)
DMEO Institutional Attachment	Established 18 September 2015 under NITI Aayog by amalgamating PEO and IEO
SDG Nodal Agency	NITI Aayog coordinates and monitors Sustainable Development Goals
Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)	Flagship entrepreneurship and innovation initiative under NITI Aayog
Imperative vs Indicative Planning	State command directives vs market-oriented guidance and incentives
Gadgil–Mukherjee Formula Weight	Population assigned the highest weightage at 60% in plan assistance
First Five-Year Plan (1951–56)	Harrod–Domar model; prioritized agriculture, irrigation, and power
Second Five-Year Plan (1956–61)	Mahalanobis heavy-industry model; "Socialistic Pattern of Society" (IPR 1956)
Plan Holiday Period	1966–1969; three consecutive Annual Plans following war and drought
Rolling Plan Period	1978–1980; initiated by Janata Party government based on Gunnar Myrdal's model
Fifth Five-Year Plan (1974–79)	"Garibi Hatao" and attainment of self-reliance; terminated early in 1978
Seventh Five-Year Plan (1985–90)	Slogan: "Food, Work and Productivity"; expansion of rural anti-poverty programs
Eighth Five-Year Plan (1992–97)	Human resource development as core; post-reform infrastructure thrust (6.8% actual growth)
Ninth Five-Year Plan (1997–2002)	Focus: "Growth with Social Justice and Equity"; Women's Component Plan
Eleventh Five-Year Plan (2007–12)	Slogan: "Towards Faster and More Inclusive Growth" (target 9% GDP)
Twelfth Five-Year Plan (2012–17)	Slogan: "Faster, More Inclusive and Sustainable Growth"; final Five-Year Plan (target 8%)
National Planning Committee (1938)	Formed by Subhash Chandra Bose; chaired by Jawaharlal Nehru
Bombay Plan (1944)	Authored by 8 leading industrialists (Tata, Birla, Shri Ram, Mathai, etc.)
Gandhian Plan (1944)	Formulated by Sriman Narayan Agarwal emphasizing cottage industries
Sarvodaya Plan (1950)	Conceptualized by Jayaprakash Narayan (JP) drawing on Gandhian ideals
India Vision 2020	Drafted by the S.P. Gupta Committee under the Planning Commission
Fiscal Health Index 2025	Odisha ranked 1st among major States; Uttar Pradesh scored 45.9 (7th)
India Innovation Index 2019–21	Karnataka ranked 1st among major States
National Income Formal Definition	Net National Product at Factor Cost (NNP_FC)
Mixed Economy Definition	Simultaneous coexistence and coordination of public and private sectors
"Hindu Rate of Growth"	Coined by Prof. Raj Krishna for ~3.5% GDP growth from 1950s to early 1980s
National Accounts Base Year	Base year 2022–23 (notified February 2026, replacing 2011–12)
Official National Income Release	National Statistical Office (NSO) under MoSPI
Pioneer National Income Estimates	Dadabhai Naoroji (1867–68, ₹20) and Dr. V.K.R.V. Rao (scientific, 1931–32)
Lowest State Per Capita Income	Bihar
Largest State Economy by GSDP	Maharashtra

Topic 2 — Public Finance, Budget, Taxation and Fiscal Policy

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **Public finance** is the branch of economics that examines government revenue generation, public expenditure, borrowing, and national debt management to accomplish economic stability and social equity.
2. **Revenue receipts** are regular, recurring earnings of the government that **neither create a financial liability nor cause a reduction in government assets**. They comprise tax revenue and non-tax revenue.
3. **Capital receipts** are receipts that **either create a financial liability** (e.g., market borrowings, external loans) **or reduce government assets** (e.g., disinvestment of PSU equity, recoveries of loans advanced to States).
4. **Revenue expenditure** represents operational outlays incurred for the normal day-to-day running of government departments and administrative services (salaries, pensions, interest payments, subsidies) that **do not create physical or financial assets**.
5. **Capital expenditure** consists of outlays that result in the **creation of durable physical/financial assets** (infrastructure, highways, schools, hospitals, equity investment) or a **reduction in financial liabilities** (repayment of public debt principal).
6. **Tax revenue** is categorized into direct taxes (corporation tax, personal income tax, securities transaction tax) and indirect taxes (GST, basic customs duties, central excise on petroleum).
7. **Non-tax revenue** includes interest receipts on loans advanced to States and public entities, dividends and profits from Public Sector Enterprises (PSUs) and the RBI, user fees, administrative penalties, and external cash grants.
8. Under **Article 112** of the Constitution, the Union Budget is officially introduced as the **Annual Financial Statement**. At the State level, the corresponding budget is presented under **Article 202**.
9. The budget documents present three distinct data sets: **Budget Estimates (BE)** for the upcoming financial year, **Revised Estimates (RE)** for the ongoing year, and **Actuals** (audited figures) for the preceding year.
10. A **Vote on Account (Article 116(a))** is an interim parliamentary authorization allowing the executive to withdraw funds from the Consolidated Fund to cover essential expenditures for a fraction of the year (usually two months) pending passage of the full Appropriation Bill.
11. Public expenditure is classified as either **voted** (requiring formal voting and approval by the Lok Sabha as Demands for Grants) or **charged upon the Consolidated Fund of India** (non-votable; discussed by Parliament but not voted upon, such as emoluments of the President, judges' salaries, and debt servicing).
12. The **Consolidated Fund of India (Article 266(1))** is the premier public treasury into which all government revenues, loans raised, and loan recoveries flow; no money can be withdrawn from it without an **Appropriation Act** passed by Parliament.
13. The **Public Account of India (Article 266(2))** accounts for moneys where the government acts as a trustee or banker (Provident Funds, postal small savings, court deposits); withdrawals do not require prior parliamentary appropriation.
14. The **Contingency Fund of India (Article 267)** is an emergency imprest fund placed at the disposal of the **President of India** to meet unforeseen, urgent national expenditures pending subsequent parliamentary sanction and replenishment from the Consolidated Fund.
15. **Revenue Deficit** is the excess of revenue expenditure over revenue receipts: **Revenue Deficit = Revenue Expenditure − Revenue Receipts**. It reflects government dissaving and borrowing to fund consumption.
16. **Fiscal Deficit** represents the total excess of government expenditure over non-debt receipts: **Fiscal Deficit = Total Expenditure − (Revenue Receipts + Non-Debt Capital Receipts)**. It precisely measures the government's **total net borrowing requirement** from all sources.
17. **Primary Deficit** isolates current fiscal operations from past debt legacies: **Primary Deficit = Fiscal Deficit − Interest Payments**. A zero primary deficit indicates that all borrowings are utilized solely to service existing debt.
18. **Effective Revenue Deficit (ERD)** is defined as Revenue Deficit minus grants-in-aid given to States for the creation of capital assets.

19. In historical budget accounting, **Budget Deficit** represented the overall net gap (Total Expenditure − Total Receipts). In modern Indian macroeconomics, the Fiscal Deficit has replaced it as the definitive metric of budgetary shortfall.
20. The **Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act, 2003** mandates institutional fiscal discipline, setting statutory targets for deficit reduction and mandating key macroeconomic disclosure statements in Parliament.
21. The **N.K. Singh FRBM Review Committee (2017)** recommended anchoring fiscal policy to a **general government debt ceiling of 60% of GDP** (40% for the Centre and 20% for the States), alongside a 3% fiscal deficit target.
22. **Direct taxes** are levied directly on the income, wealth, or profits of individuals and corporate entities; the statutory incidence and real economic burden fall on the same entity (non-shiftable).
23. **Indirect taxes** are levied on the manufacture, sale, or consumption of goods and services; the taxpayer shifts the tax incidence to the final consumer through market pricing.
24. A **progressive tax** levies higher percentage tax rates as the income base increases. A **proportional tax** maintains an unchanging percentage rate across all income levels. A **regressive tax** consumes a larger percentage of income from low-income earners than from high-income earners.
25. The Indian personal income tax system is structurally characterized as **degressive**: progressive across introductory and middle income slabs, but leveling into a proportional top marginal rate for upper income brackets.
26. The **Goods and Services Tax (GST)** is a comprehensive, multi-stage, destination-based consumption tax levied on the supply of goods and services, eliminating cascading ("tax on tax") through seamless **Input Tax Credit (ITC)**.
27. GST was introduced through the **101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016**, and rolled out nationally on **1 July 2017**.
28. India operates a **Dual GST model**: **CGST** (Central GST) and **SGST / UTGST** (State/UT GST) are levied concurrently on intra-State supplies; **IGST** (Integrated GST) is levied on inter-State commerce and imports.
29. GST subsumed 17 major central and state levies, including Central Excise Duty, Service Tax, State VAT, Entry Tax, Luxury Tax, and Entertainment Tax. Corporate tax, personal income tax, and basic customs duty were **not** subsumed.
30. The **GST Council (Article 279A)** is a constitutional federal forum chaired by the **Union Finance Minister**. The Centre holds a **one-third** voting weight, all States combined hold a **two-thirds** weight, and decisions require a **three-fourths majority** of weighted votes present.
31. **Basic Customs Duty** remains outside GST and continues as a border tariff. Residual **Central Excise** continues to be levied on select non-GST goods (petroleum crude, motor spirit, high-speed diesel, natural gas, aviation turbine fuel, and tobacco).
32. The proposed **Direct Tax Code (DTC)** was conceptualized to overhaul and consolidate direct tax legislation, principally replacing the archaic **Income Tax Act, 1961**.
33. The **Tobin Tax** is a theoretical levy proposed by Nobel laureate James Tobin on spot **foreign-exchange transactions** to discourage short-term volatile currency speculation.
34. The **Finance Commission** is a constitutional body established under **Article 280** of the Constitution, constituted by the President of India every five years or earlier.
35. The Finance Commission consists of a **Chairman and four other members** appointed by the President.
36. Under Article 280(2), **Parliament by law determines the qualifications** and selection procedure of Commission members (**Finance Commission Act, 1951**); the President does not prescribe qualifications.
37. Under Article 280(3), the Commission submits its recommendations to the **President of India**, who causes them, along with an explanatory memorandum, to be laid before Parliament under **Article 281**. It does **not report to NITI Aayog**.

38. The statutory mandate of the Finance Commission comprises: recommending the distribution of the net divisible pool of taxes between the Union and States (vertical devolution); allocation among States (horizontal devolution); principles governing **grants-in-aid (Article 275)**; and measures to augment State Consolidated Funds to supplement local bodies.
39. The **First Finance Commission** was instituted in 1951 under the chairmanship of **K.C. Neogy** (award period 1952–57).
40. The **14th Finance Commission (Dr. Y.V. Reddy)** recommended an unprecedented increase in vertical devolution to States from 32% to **42%** of the divisible pool. The **15th Finance Commission (N.K. Singh)** adjusted this to **41%** following the conversion of Jammu & Kashmir into Union Territories.
41. Historical Chairmen of Finance Commissions: **11th A.M. Khusro**, **12th Dr. C. Rangarajan**, **13th Dr. Vijay Kelkar**, **14th Dr. Y.V. Reddy**, and **15th N.K. Singh**.
42. **State Finance Commissions (Articles 243-I and 243-Y)** are constituted by State Governors every five years to review the financial position of Panchayats and Municipalities.
43. Under **Article 113(3)**, no Demand for Grant can be introduced in the Lok Sabha except on the **recommendation of the President of India**.
44. **Cut Motions** in Lok Sabha: A **Policy Cut** reduces the demand amount to **₹1** (disapproval of policy); an **Economy Cut** reduces it by a specified lump sum; a **Token Cut** reduces it by **₹100** (ventilating a specific grievance).
45. **Zero-Based Budgeting (ZBB)**, pioneered by Peter Pyhrr in the United States, requires every budget program to be justified from a zero base each financial year rather than incrementally building on historical allocations. India introduced ZBB experimentally in the Department of Science and Technology in the mid-1980s.
46. The **2017–18 Union Budget** instituted three structural reforms: advanced budget presentation to **1 February**, merged the 92-year-old standalone **Railway Budget** with the General Budget, and abolished the traditional **Plan vs Non-Plan expenditure** distinction.
47. **Interest payments** constitute the largest single component of revenue expenditure in the Union Budget, reflecting the accumulated public debt stock.
48. **Project Saksham** is an integrated indirect tax IT modernization project approved in 2016 for CBEC (now CBIC) to support the digital rollout of GST and customs processing.
49. The **Direct Taxes Committee** (Kelkar Task Force, 2002) laid the foundation for rationalized personal income tax slabs and recommended the conceptual design of GST.
50. **Tax Buoyancy** measures the responsiveness of tax revenue growth relative to GDP growth: **Tax Buoyancy = (% Change in Tax Revenue) / (% Change in GDP)**. A buoyancy greater than 1 signifies that tax collections expand faster than the underlying national output.

📋 Must-Score Drill — Funds, Deficits, Taxes, and Commissions

Public Finance Term or Institution	Core Constitutional / Economic Anchor
Consolidated Fund of India	Article 266(1); requires parliamentary Appropriation Act
Public Account of India	Article 266(2); trust moneys, deposits, small savings
Contingency Fund of India	Article 267; emergency imprest at President's disposal
Annual Financial Statement	Article 112 (Union) and Article 202 (States)
No Taxation Without Law	Article 265
Finance Commission Mandate	Article 280; Chairman + 4 members; reports to President
Finance Commission Qualifications	Prescribed by Parliament under Finance Commission Act, 1951
First Finance Commission Chairman	K.C. Neogy (1952–57); 2nd K. Santhanam; 14th Y.V. Reddy; 15th N.K. Singh
16th Finance Commission Chairman	Dr. Arvind Panagariya (constituted 31 Dec 2023; operational period 2026–31)
14th / 15th FC Vertical Devolution	42% (14th FC) and 41% (15th FC; adjusted 1% for J&K and Ladakh)

Public Finance Term or Institution	Core Constitutional / Economic Anchor
Goods and Services Tax Amendment	101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016 (rolled out 1 July 2017)
GST Council Composition	Article 279A; chaired by Union Finance Minister; 3/4th weighted vote threshold
Fiscal Deficit Formula	Total Expenditure − (Revenue Receipts + Non-Debt Capital Receipts)
Primary Deficit Formula	Fiscal Deficit − Interest Payments
Revenue Deficit Formula	Revenue Expenditure − Revenue Receipts
Monetized Deficit Formula	Net increase in RBI credit to the Central Government
Ad-hoc T-Bills Abolition & WMA	Ad-hoc T-bills abolished on 31 March 1997; WMA introduced 1 April 1997 (repayable in 90 days)
FRBM Act Year & Debt Anchor	Enacted 2003; N.K. Singh Committee proposed 60% general government debt (40% Centre + 20% States)
Direct Tax Code Domain	Reform and modernization of Income Tax and Wealth Tax legislation
Tobin Tax Target	Spot foreign exchange transactions to penalize currency speculation
Demand for Grant Recommendation	Article 113(3); requires prior recommendation of the President
Vote of Credit ("Blank Cheque")	Article 116(1)(b); lump-sum grant for unexpected demands of indefinite magnitude
Excess Grant Scrutiny	Article 115; requires mandatory examination and recommendation by the PAC
Performance Budgeting Inception	1968 in India (recommended by First ARC; originated from US Hoover Commission)
Zero-Based Budgeting (ZBB)	Originated in USA (Peter Pyhrr, 1970); introduced experimentally in India in 1986
Outcome Budgeting Inception	Union Budget 2005–06 (monitoring by Ministry of Finance and Planning Commission)
Gender Budgeting Inception	Union Budget 2005–06 (Statement 20; Part A 100% women, Part B 30–99%)
Long-Term Fiscal Policy (LTFP)	December 1985 by V.P. Singh (synchronizing tax policy with 7th Five-Year Plan)
Budget 2017–18 Triple Reforms	1 Feb presentation, Railway Budget merger (after 92 yrs / Acworth Comm.), Plan/Non-Plan abolished
Policy Cut vs Token Cut	Demand reduced to ₹1 (Policy Cut); Demand reduced by ₹100 (Token Cut)
Expenditure / Wealth / Gift Tax Pioneer	Nicholas Kaldor (1956 Tax Reform Report)
Direct Taxes Enquiry (Black Money)	Wanchoo Committee (1971)
Service Tax Committee	Raja J. Chelliah Committee (introduced 1994–95 on 3 services at 5%)
First State to Implement VAT	Haryana (2003); nationwide rollout 1 April 2005; Uttar Pradesh adopted last in 2008
Minimum Alternate Tax (MAT - 115JB)	Budget 1996–97 by P. Chidambaram; taxes book profits of "zero-tax companies"
Abolished Historical Direct Taxes	Estate Duty (abolished 1985), Wealth Tax (abolished 2015–16), Interest Tax (2001)
PAN Card 4th Character	Denotes legal status: P = Individual/Person, C = Company, H = HUF, F = Firm, T = Trust
PAN Card Usage Restriction	Proof of identity, DOB, tax status; CANNOT be used as proof of address
Project e-Sahyog	Launched October 2015 by CBDT for digital resolution of tax mismatches
Largest Revenue Expenditure Head	Interest payments on accumulated public debt
Taxes Outside GST Domain	Basic customs duties, alcohol for human consumption, stamp duties, petroleum (pending notification)
Project Saksham	CBIC IT infrastructure network supporting digital GST implementation
Degressive Tax Definition	Slabs rise progressively at first, then settle into a flat proportional rate

Topic 3 — Money, Banking, RBI and Financial System

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **Money** performs four classical macroeconomic functions: a **medium of exchange**, a **unit of account**, a **store of value**, and a **standard of deferred payment**.
2. **Fiat money** possesses value by virtue of government decree and legal tender status, rather than intrinsic commodity value (such as gold or silver coins). All circulating currency notes and coins in India are fiat money.
3. In Indian monetary economics, **M1 (Narrow Money)** is defined as: **M1 = Currency with the Public + Demand Deposits with Banking System + Other Deposits with RBI**. It represents the most liquid monetary aggregate.
4. **M3 (Broad Money)** is the most widely cited measure of aggregate money supply, defined as: **M3 = M1 + Time Deposits (Fixed Deposits) with the Banking System**.
5. **Reserve Money (M0 or High-Powered Money)** represents central bank liabilities: **M0 = Currency in Circulation + Bankers' Deposits with RBI + Other Deposits with RBI**.
6. The **Money Multiplier (m)** measures the ratio of broad money supply to reserve money: **m = M3 / M0**. It reflects the capacity of commercial banks to generate credit and secondary deposits from their primary cash reserves.
7. Under Section 42(6) of the RBI Act, 1934, **Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs)** are banks that satisfy minimum paid-up capital requirements (at least ₹5 lakh historically) and are listed in the **Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**.
8. India's commercial banking architecture comprises **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**, **Private Sector Banks**, **Foreign Banks**, **Regional Rural Banks (RRBs)**, and specialized differentiated banks (**Small Finance Banks** and **Payments Banks**).
9. Under RBI guidelines, **Priority Sector Lending (PSL)** mandates that domestic Scheduled Commercial Banks allocate at least **40% of their Adjusted Net Bank Credit (ANBC)** or credit equivalent of off-balance sheet exposure to designated priority sectors (including Agriculture, Micro/Small Enterprises, Education, Housing, Export Credit, Social Infrastructure, and Renewable Energy). Foreign banks with 20 or more branches carry the identical 40% PSL mandate.
10. A **Non-Performing Asset (NPA)** is defined as a loan or advance where interest and/or installment of principal remains **overdue for a period exceeding 90 days** in the case of a term loan.
11. **Gross NPA** reflects the total quantum of bad loans on a bank's balance sheet, while **Net NPA** deducts cumulative provisioning (funds set aside out of profits to absorb anticipated losses) from Gross NPA: **Net NPA = Gross NPA − Provisions**.
12. **Payments Banks** (instituted on recommendations of the Nachiket Mor Committee) are permitted to accept demand deposits (currently capped at ₹2 lakh per individual customer), facilitate digital payments and remittances, and issue ATM/debit cards. They are **strictly prohibited from issuing credit cards or granting loans**.
13. **Small Finance Banks (SFBs)** are full-fledged niche commercial banks mandated to deliver savings and credit vehicles to unserved and underserved segments, including micro-enterprises and marginal farmers. They must maintain a higher PSL target of **75% of ANBC**.
14. The **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** was developed by the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** and launched in 2016, enabling instant, real-time account-to-account mobile fund transfers.
15. The **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)**, launched on **28 August 2014**, represents the world's largest financial inclusion program, providing universal access to basic banking accounts (Basic Savings Bank Deposit Account - BSBDA) with zero minimum balance, RuPay debit cards, and accident insurance coverage.
16. The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** was established on **1 April 1935** in Calcutta (later moved permanently to Mumbai in 1937) under the **Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, based on the recommendations of the **Royal Commission on Indian Currency and Finance (Hilton Young Commission, 1926)**.

17. The RBI was originally founded as a private shareholders' bank and was formally nationalized on **1 January 1949** under the *Reserve Bank (Transfer to Public Ownership) Act, 1948*.
18. Core statutory functions of the RBI include: functioning as the **Monetary Authority**; **Sole Issuer of Banknotes** (Section 22); **Banker and Public Debt Manager to the Central and State Governments**; **Bankers' Bank and Lender of Last Resort**; **Regulator and Supervisor of the Banking System** (under Banking Regulation Act, 1949); and **Custodian and Manager of Foreign Exchange Reserves** (under Foreign Exchange Management Act, 1999).
19. Under Section 22 of the RBI Act, the RBI possesses the exclusive right to issue banknotes in India of denominations from ₹2 to ₹10,000. **One Rupee notes and all metallic coins are issued by the Ministry of Finance (Government of India)**, and One Rupee notes bear the signature of the **Finance Secretary**, not the RBI Governor.
20. The **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)** was institutionalized in 2016 under Section 45ZB of the amended RBI Act. It comprises **six members**: three from RBI (including the Governor as ex-officio Chairperson, Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy, and one RBI official) and three external experts appointed by the Central Government. The Governor exercises a casting vote in the event of a tie.
21. The statutory monetary policy objective is **flexible inflation targeting**: anchoring headline Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation at **4% with a tolerance band of ±2%** (between 2% and 6%).
22. The **Policy Repo Rate** is the benchmark interest rate at which the RBI provides overnight liquidity to commercial banks against the collateral of eligible government securities under the Liquidity Adjustment Facility (LAF).
23. The **Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)**, introduced in April 2022, serves as the operational floor of the LAF corridor, allowing the RBI to absorb surplus liquidity from commercial banks without requiring the provision of government securities as collateral.
24. The **Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)** represents the specified fraction of Net Demand and Time Liabilities (NDTL) that commercial banks must maintain in liquid cash balances with the Reserve Bank of India. Under the RBI Act (post-2007 amendment), the RBI **pays no interest** on cash balances held under CRR.
25. The **Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)** mandates that commercial banks maintain a specified percentage of their NDTL in approved, unencumbered liquid assets (chiefly Government Securities / Treasury Bills, cash, and gold) within the bank itself before deploying credit.
26. The **Marginal Standing Facility (MSF)** is an emergency penal borrowing window introduced in 2011, enabling scheduled commercial banks to borrow overnight funds from RBI by dipping into their mandatory SLR quota up to an approved limit at an interest rate pegged above the repo rate.
27. **Open Market Operations (OMOs)** involve the outright sale or purchase of government securities in the secondary market by the RBI to absorb or inject durable liquidity into the banking system.
28. **Financial inclusion** denotes the delivery of formal banking, credit, insurance, and payment services at affordable terms to vulnerable, low-income, and marginalized segments of society.
29. The **Lead Bank Scheme (LBS)** was initiated by the RBI in **1969** following recommendations of the Gadgil Study Group and Nariman Committee, assigning each district to a designated commercial bank (the "Lead Bank") to coordinate district-wide credit deployment.
30. The first major wave of commercial bank nationalization occurred on **19 July 1969**, when **14 major private commercial banks** (with deposit bases of ₹50 crore or more) were nationalized under the Indira Gandhi administration.
31. The second wave of commercial bank nationalization took place on **15 April 1980**, nationalizing **6 additional commercial banks** (with deposit bases of ₹200 crore or more).
32. **Regional Rural Banks (RRBs)** were inaugurated on **2 October 1975** (formalized by the RRB Act, 1976) following the recommendations of the Narasimham Working Group. The first RRB established was **Prathama Bank** (headquartered in Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh, sponsored by Syndicate Bank). The equity capital of RRBs is held in the ratio: **50% Central Government, 15% State Government, and 35% Sponsor Bank**.
33. The **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)** was established on **12 July 1982** under the *NABARD Act, 1981*, based on the recommendations of the **Committee to Review Arrangements for**

Institutional Credit for Agriculture and Rural Development (CRAFICARD / B. Sivaraman Committee), replacing the Agricultural Refinance and Development Corporation (ARDC).

34. The **Self-Help Group (SHG) – Bank Linkage Programme** was piloted by **NABARD in 1992–93**, linking informal women's thrift groups with commercial banks, transforming rural micro-finance into a mainstream banking vehicle.
35. The **Kisan Credit Card (KCC)** scheme was formulated by NABARD in **1998** on the recommendations of the **R.V. Gupta Committee**, providing flexible, single-window short-term credit to farmers for crop cultivation, post-harvest expenses, and farm asset maintenance.
36. The **Bhandari Committee (1994)** was appointed by the Government of India to recommend structural reorganization, financial restructuring, and recapitalization of Regional Rural Banks.
37. The **Narasimham Committee on Financial System (1991 - Committee I)** recommended systemic deregulation: lowering mandatory CRR and SLR, phasing out directed lending, introducing prudential accounting norms (NPA classification and Capital Adequacy), and permitting entry of new private sector banks.
38. The **Narasimham Committee on Banking Sector Reforms (1998 - Committee II)** recommended bank mergers to create strong international institutions, asset reconstruction companies, and autonomy in public sector bank management.
39. The **High-Level Committee on Financial Sector Reforms (2008)**, chaired by **Dr. Raghuram Rajan**, recommended a shift toward principle-based regulation, electronic inclusion, and institutional development of corporate bond markets.
40. The **Financial Stability and Development Council (FSDC)** was established in **December 2010** on the recommendation of the Raghuram Rajan Committee. It is chaired by the **Union Finance Minister** and includes heads of all financial regulators (RBI, SEBI, IRDAI, PFRDA, IFSCA); it is not an organ of NITI Aayog.
41. Project **Swabhimaan** was launched on **10 February 2011** by the Ministry of Finance and Indian Banks' Association as a nationwide financial inclusion drive to provide banking services to unbanked villages having a population exceeding 2,000.
42. Credit Rating Agencies in India (CRISIL, ICRA, CARE) are legally regulated by the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** under the SEBI (Credit Rating Agencies) Regulations, 1999, not by the RBI. Historical inception: **CRISIL (1987) → ICRA (1991) → CARE (1993)**.
43. The **Banking Ombudsman Scheme** was instituted by the RBI under Section 35A of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949, providing a free, expeditious grievance redressal forum for bank customers; decisions of the Ombudsman can be appealed to the Appellate Authority (Deputy Governor, RBI).
44. In financial terminology, **"Plastic Money"** refers to payment cards (credit cards and debit cards) that replace conventional paper currency notes in retail transactions.
45. Under Section 45ZB of the RBI Act, each member of the Monetary Policy Committee has one vote; in the event of an equality of votes, the **Governor of the Reserve Bank of India has a second or casting vote**.
46. The **State Bank of India (SBI)** was established on **1 July 1955** under the *State Bank of India Act, 1955*, nationalizing the erstwhile **Imperial Bank of India** (which had been created in 1921 through the merger of the three Presidency Banks of Bengal, Bombay, and Madras), based on recommendations of the **All India Rural Credit Survey Committee (A.D. Gorwala Committee)**.
47. **Basel Accords** are global prudential regulatory standards formulated by the Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (BCBS) setting Capital to Risk-Weighted Assets Ratios (CRAR) to shield banks against solvency crises. Under RBI norms, commercial banks must maintain a minimum CRAR of **9%** (higher than the international Basel III requirement of 8%).
48. A bank is described as providing **"Lender of Last Resort"** facilities when the central bank provides emergency liquidity credit to solvent financial institutions facing temporary, panic-driven liquidity shortfalls.
49. **Currency Appreciation** occurs in a floating exchange-rate system when the market value of the domestic currency increases relative to a foreign currency, making imports cheaper and exports relatively more expensive.
50. In the banking sector, the term **NIM (Net Interest Margin)** represents the difference between the interest income generated by banks on loans/advances and the interest amount paid out to depositors, expressed as a

percentage of total interest-earning assets.

📋 Must-Score Drill — Institutional Chronology & Regulatory Levers

Financial Institution or Regulatory Tool	Core Conceptual Anchor / Chronological Date
RBI Inception & Nationalization	Established 1 April 1935 (Hilton Young Commission); Nationalized 1 January 1949
Note Issuing Authority	Section 22 of RBI Act, 1934; ₹1 note issued by Ministry of Finance
Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)	Section 45ZB of RBI Act; 6 members; Governor chairs with casting vote
Inflation Target Benchmark	4% CPI headline inflation with a tolerance band of ±2% (2% to 6%)
Imperial Bank to SBI Transition	State Bank of India Act, 1955 (Gorwala Committee); effective 1 July 1955
First Commercial Bank Nationalization	19 July 1969; 14 major private commercial banks
Lead Bank Scheme	Introduced 1969 on Gadgil Study Group and Nariman Committee advice
First Regional Rural Bank (RRB)	Prathama Bank (Moradabad, UP); 2 October 1975 (Narasimham Working Group)
NABARD Inception	12 July 1982 under Act 61 of 1981 (CRAFICARD / B. Sivaraman Committee)
SHG-Bank Linkage Programme	Formulated and piloted by NABARD in 1992–93
Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Launch	1998; model formulated by NABARD (R.V. Gupta Committee)
Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)	Introduced April 2022 as uncollateralized liquidity absorption floor
Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)	Kept with RBI as liquid cash; earns zero interest under RBI Act
Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)	Maintained by banks in approved G-Secs, cash, and gold
Marginal Standing Facility (MSF)	Introduced 2011; overnight penal emergency window dipping into SLR
Priority Sector Lending (PSL) Target	40% of ANBC for domestic Scheduled Commercial Banks
Small Finance Banks PSL Mandate	75% of ANBC allocated to priority sectors
Payments Bank Deposit Ceiling	₹2 lakh per individual; cannot advance loans or issue credit cards
Narasimham Committee I & II	1991 (financial deregulation) and 1998 (banking structural consolidation)
Financial Stability Council (FSDC)	December 2010; chaired by Union Finance Minister
Credit Rating Agency Regulator	SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India)
Bhandari Committee (1994)	Restructuring and capital rehabilitation of Regional Rural Banks
Swabhimaan Campaign	10 February 2011; banking in villages with population >2,000
"One State, One RRB" Consolidation	Merger of 26 RRBs, reducing national count from 43 to 28

Topic 4 — Inflation, Prices, Savings, Investment and Markets

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **Inflation** is defined as a sustained, general increase in the price level of goods and services in an economy over a period of time, resulting in a persistent erosion in the purchasing power of money.
2. **Deflation** is a persistent, general decline in the overall price level (negative inflation rate), often accompanied by economic contraction.
3. **Disinflation** represents a deceleration in the **rate of inflation**; prices continue to rise, but at a visibly slower pace (e.g., inflation declining from 7% to 4%).
4. **Stagflation** is an adverse macroeconomic condition characterized by the simultaneous persistence of high inflation, stagnant economic output, and high unemployment.
5. **Demand-Pull Inflation** arises when aggregate demand for goods and services outpaces aggregate supply in an economy operating near full productive capacity ("too much money chasing too few goods").
6. **Cost-Push Inflation** is triggered by supply-side disruptions or an increase in the costs of production (e.g., surging international crude oil prices, rising wages, or imported raw material costs) that push up unit output prices.
7. **Structural or Bottleneck Inflation** arises from structural rigidities, inadequate physical infrastructure, poor storage facilities, and agricultural supply chain bottlenecks common in developing economies.
8. **Headline Inflation** measures total inflation across the entire commodity basket, including volatile food and energy products.
9. **Core Inflation** isolates the underlying, durable inflation trend by excluding volatile food and fuel prices from the headline basket.
10. In India, **headline retail inflation** for monetary policy formulation is officially measured by the **Consumer Price Index (Combined)**.
11. The **CPI (Combined)** is compiled and released monthly by the **National Statistical Office (NSO)** under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).
12. Sector-specific CPI indices—**CPI-IW (Industrial Workers)**, **CPI-AL (Agricultural Labourers)**, and **CPI-RL (Rural Labourers)**—are compiled by the **Labour Bureau** under the Ministry of Labour and Employment.
13. The **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** measures price changes at the wholesale transaction level; it covers only physical goods and **completely excludes services**.
14. The **WPI** is compiled and published monthly by the **Office of the Economic Adviser (OEA)**, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), **Ministry of Commerce and Industry** (base year 2011–12).
15. In WPI, **Manufactured Products** hold the highest weight (64.2%), followed by **Primary Articles** (22.6%) and **Fuel & Power** (13.2%). In CPI Combined, **Food and Beverages** carry the largest weight (approximately 45.9%).
16. The **GDP Deflator** is the ratio of Nominal GDP to Real GDP multiplied by 100: **GDP Deflator = (Nominal GDP / Real GDP) × 100**. It is the most comprehensive measure of domestic output price levels.
17. The **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)** measures the physical **volume of industrial production** across Mining, Manufacturing, and Electricity; it is a volume index, not a price index.
18. During periods of unanticipated inflation, **debtors (borrowers) gain** in real terms because they repay loans in currency that has lost purchasing power. Conversely, **creditors (lenders), bondholders, and fixed-income earners lose** purchasing power.
19. The **Real Interest Rate** approximates the nominal interest rate minus the rate of inflation (Fisher Equation): **Real Interest Rate ≈ Nominal Rate − Inflation**. When inflation exceeds nominal returns, the real return turns negative.
20. Macroeconomic measures to curb inflation include: monetary tightening (hiking repo rate, raising CRR/SLR), fiscal consolidation (reducing fiscal deficit and public spending), and supply-side interventions (releasing food buffer stocks, reducing import duties on essential commodities).

21. **Savings** represents the portion of disposable national income that is not spent on current final consumption.
22. In India, the **household sector** is the single largest contributor to gross domestic savings, followed by the private corporate sector and the public sector.
23. Within Indian household savings, **physical assets** (real estate, gold, physical capital) historically account for a larger share than financial assets (bank deposits, shares, pensions).
24. **Gross Capital Formation (GCF)** represents the net addition to the physical fixed capital stock of the economy (machinery, infrastructure, factories) plus changes in inventories during an accounting year.
25. A **high Capital–Output Ratio (COR)** or Incremental Capital–Output Ratio (ICOR) signifies that substantial capital investments produce comparatively low output increments, indicating capital inefficiency.
26. In macroeconomic equilibrium within a closed economy, aggregate savings equal aggregate investment (**Savings = Investment (S = I)**). In an open economy, domestic investment equals domestic savings plus net capital inflows from abroad.
27. **Financial markets** channel surplus financial resources from net savers (principally households) to productive borrowers and investors (corporations and government).
28. The **Money Market** deals in short-term credit instruments with maturities of **up to one year** (364 days). Core instruments include Treasury Bills, Commercial Paper, Certificates of Deposit, Call Money, and Notice Money.
29. The **Capital Market** deals in medium- and long-term funds (maturities exceeding one year). It comprises the **Equity Market** (shares providing ownership stakes) and the **Debt Market** (bonds and debentures providing fixed income).
30. In the money market, **Call Money** refers to inter-bank borrowing for **one day (overnight)**; **Notice Money** refers to borrowing for **2 to 14 days**; and **Term Money** covers borrowing for periods beyond **14 days up to one year**.
31. **Treasury Bills (T-Bills)** are short-term promissory notes issued by the RBI on behalf of the Government of India to finance temporary cash mismatches. They are issued at a discount and redeemed at face value, with standard maturities of **91 days, 182 days, and 364 days**. State Governments **do not issue T-bills**.
32. **Commercial Paper (CP)** is an unsecured short-term promissory note issued by highly rated corporate entities to raise working capital directly from the market (maturities between 7 days and 1 year).
33. **Certificates of Deposit (CDs)** are negotiable, dematerialized promissory notes issued by commercial banks and financial institutions against term deposits (minimum tenure 7 days for banks).
34. The **Primary Market** is the segment of the capital market where new securities are issued for the very first time to raise fresh capital (Initial Public Offering - IPO, Follow-on Public Offering - FPO, Rights Issue).
35. The **Secondary Market** (Stock Exchange) is the platform where existing, previously issued securities are traded among investors, providing continuous liquidity.
36. The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** is the statutory apex regulator of securities and capital markets in India. Established on 12 April 1988 by executive resolution, it was granted **full statutory status on 30 January 1992** via the *SEBI Act, 1992*.
37. **Mutual Funds** are investment vehicles that pool capital from multiple individual and institutional investors to purchase diversified portfolios of equities, debt, or money market securities under SEBI regulations.
38. **Net Asset Value (NAV)** represents the market value per share/unit of a mutual fund portfolio: **NAV = (Total Assets − Liabilities) / Total Outstanding Units**.
39. The **Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE)** is Asia's oldest stock exchange (established in 1875 as the Native Share and Stock Brokers' Association); its benchmark index is the **S&P BSE Sensex**, comprising **30 large, liquid, representative stocks**.
40. The **National Stock Exchange (NSE)** was incorporated in 1992 and commenced operations in 1994; its flagship benchmark index is the **Nifty 50**, tracking **50 leading diversified companies**.
41. Depository systems in India convert physical share certificates into electronic book entries (**dematerialization**). India has two national depositories: **National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL)**, established in **1996**, and **Central Depository Services Limited (CDSL)**, established in **1999**.

42. **Masala Bonds** are Rupee-denominated debt instruments issued by Indian entities in overseas capital markets. Their primary economic advantage is that **currency exchange rate risk is borne by the overseas investor**, not the Indian borrower.
43. **Sovereign Gold Bonds (SGBs)** are government securities denominated in grams of gold issued by the RBI on behalf of the Government of India to mobilize idle domestic gold demand into paper investments, paying a fixed annual coupon interest alongside capital appreciation linked to gold prices.
44. **Creeping Inflation** represents a mild, gradual increase in prices (typically up to 3% annually), generally considered manageable and supportive of economic expansion.
45. **Walking or Trotting Inflation** is moderate inflation (typically between 3% and 10% annually), signaling the need for active monetary intervention.
46. **Running or Galloping Inflation** occurs when prices rise at a double- or triple-digit pace (10% to 100%+ annually), distorting price mechanisms and undermining long-term investments.
47. **Hyperinflation** is an extreme economic crisis where prices escalate out of control (exceeding 50% monthly), rendering national paper currency virtually worthless.
48. **Reflation** is an intentional macroeconomic stimulus policy enacted by monetary or fiscal authorities to raise prices and restore aggregate demand following a period of economic recession or deflation.
49. **Imported Inflation** occurs when a country experiences domestic price inflation as a direct consequence of rising prices of imported essential commodities (such as crude oil, fertilizers, and edible oils) or the steep depreciation of the domestic currency.
50. The **National Pension System (NPS)** is a voluntary, defined-contribution, market-linked pension framework regulated by the **Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)**.

📋 Must-Score Drill — Price Indices, Market Levers & Regulators

Economic Concept or Market Instrument	Core Characteristic / Regulatory Authority
Official Retail Inflation Index	Consumer Price Index (CPI Combined)
CPI Compiling Organization	National Statistical Office (NSO), MoSPI
WPI Compiling Organization	Office of Economic Adviser (OEA), DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce and Industry
Services in Price Indices	Included in CPI; completely excluded from WPI
Core Inflation Definition	Headline inflation excluding volatile food and fuel components
RBI Inflation Targeting Mandate	4% CPI Combined with a tolerance band of ±2% (2% to 6%)
Winners in Inflation	Debtors (borrowers)
Losers in Inflation	Creditors (lenders), bondholders, pensioners, and fixed-income earners
Structural / Bottleneck Inflation	Supply bottlenecks, transport delays, and storage deficits
Treasury Bills Issuer & Tenures	RBI on behalf of GoI; 91-day, 182-day, and 364-day maturities
Inter-Bank Money Market Tenures	Call Money (1 day), Notice Money (2–14 days), Term Money (>14 days)
Commercial Paper (CP)	Short-term unsecured promissory note issued by corporates
SEBI Inception & Statutory Status	Established 1988; granted statutory status on 30 January 1992 (SEBI Act, 1992)
Depository Institutions in India	NSDL (1996) and CDSL (1999)
BSE Sensex vs NSE Nifty Count	30 companies (Sensex); 50 companies (Nifty)
Masala Bonds Currency Risk	Rupee-denominated; currency risk borne by overseas investor
Pension Market Regulator	PFRDA (Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority)

Topic 5 — Agriculture and Indian Agricultural Economy

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. Agriculture and allied sectors contribute approximately **17%–18% of India's Gross Value Added (GVA)** at current prices, but engage **~45%–47% of the nation's total workforce**.
2. According to the **Agricultural Census of India** (conducted quinquennially since 1970–71), agricultural holdings are classified into 5 categories: **Marginal (< 1.00 ha)**, **Small (1.00–2.00 ha)**, **Semi-Medium (2.00–4.00 ha)**, **Medium (4.00–10.00 ha)**, and **Large (≥ 10.00 ha)**.
3. **Small and Marginal Farmers (SMFs, holding < 2.0 ha)** account for **~86.2% of all operational land holdings** in India, but operate only **~47.3% of the total operated area**.
4. **Marginal holdings (< 1.0 ha)** alone constitute **68.5%** of all agricultural land holdings in India, with an average operational size of just **0.38 hectare**.
5. The all-India average size of operational land holdings has consistently declined from **2.28 hectares in 1970–71** to **1.08 hectares in 2015–16** due to generational land subdivision and population pressure.
6. The state having the **highest average size of operational land holdings** in India is **Nagaland** (~5.06 ha) followed by **Punjab** (~3.62 ha) and **Rajasthan** (~2.73 ha); **Kerala** has among the lowest (~0.18 ha).
7. India is divided into **15 broad Agro-Climatic Zones** by the Planning Commission (1988) based on physiography, climate, soil, and cropping patterns; ICAR under NARP classifies India into **127 Agro-Climatic Zones** (and Uttar Pradesh into **9 zones**).
8. **Kharif crops (खरीफ)** are sown with the onset of the South-West Monsoon in **June–July** and harvested in **September–October**; major crops include **Rice, Maize, Jowar, Bajra, Cotton, Jute, Groundnut, Soybean, Tur/Arhar, Urad, and Moong**.
9. **Rabi crops (रबी)** are sown in **October–November** (winter onset) and harvested in **March–April** (spring); major crops include **Wheat, Barley, Gram (चना), Mustard (सरसों), Linseed (अलसी), Peas (मटर), and Potato**.
10. **Zaid crops (जायद)** are short-duration summer crops grown from **March to June** between Rabi harvest and Kharif sowing; predominantly include cucurbitaceous crops: **Watermelon (तरबूज), Muskmelon (खरबूजा), Cucumber (खीरा), Bitter gourd (करेला), Moong, and leafy vegetables/fodder**.
11. India is the **world's largest producer** of **Milk, Pulses, Jute, and Spices**; and the **second-largest producer** of **Rice, Wheat, Sugarcane, Groundnut, Vegetables, Fruits, and Cotton** (after China).
12. India is the **largest exporter of Rice** in the world (accounting for ~40% of global rice trade), but is the **largest importer of Pulses and Vegetable Edible Oils**.
13. **Rice (चावल)** is the **most cultivated crop in India**, occupying the largest gross cropped area (~47 million hectares); **West Bengal** is the largest producer of Rice, while **Punjab** has the highest per-hectare productivity.
14. **Wheat (गेहूं)** is the second most important cereal crop in India, occupying ~31 million hectares; **Uttar Pradesh** is the largest producer of Wheat in terms of total absolute output, while **Punjab** records the highest yield/productivity per hectare.
15. **Shree Anna (श्री अन्न / Millets)** was championed by India, leading the UN to declare **2023 as the International Year of Millets**; **Rajasthan** is the largest producer of **Bajra** (Pearl Millet), while **Karnataka/Maharashtra** lead in **Jowar** (Sorghum).
16. Among pulses, **Gram (चना)** accounts for the largest share (~45%–50% of total pulse production in India); **Madhya Pradesh** is the largest pulse-producing state in India.
17. In oilseeds, **Soybean** and **Groundnut** lead production; **Madhya Pradesh & Maharashtra** lead in Soybean, **Gujarat** leads in Groundnut, and **Rajasthan** leads in Rapeseed & Mustard.
18. **Sugarcane (गन्ना)** is a perennial tropical cash crop; **Uttar Pradesh** is the largest producer of Sugarcane and Sugar in India, but Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu record higher sucrose content and recovery rates due to maritime tropical climate.

19. **Cotton (कपास - White Gold)** is predominantly grown in the black regur soil of the Deccan plateau; **Gujarat** and **Maharashtra** are the top producing states.
20. In Net Irrigated Area across India, the source-wise share is: **Tube-wells & Wells (~62%–64%)**, followed by **Canals (~23%–25%)**, and **Tanks (~3%–4%)**.
21. **Uttar Pradesh** possesses the largest canal network and largest tube-well irrigated area in absolute terms in India; **Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh** lead in **Tank irrigation**.
22. The **Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY)** was launched in **2015** with the motto *"Har Khet Ko Pani"* and *"Per Drop More Crop"* (focused on micro-irrigation: drip and sprinkler).
23. The ideal, scientifically balanced consumption ratio of **NPK fertilizers** is **4 : 2 : 1** (N:P:K); in high-subsidy states like Punjab and Haryana, the actual consumption ratio has severely skewed to over **8 : 3 : 1**.
24. **Urea** is the ONLY fertilizer whose **Maximum Retail Price (MRP) is statutorily fixed** by the Central Government; the difference between the normative delivered cost and the controlled MRP is paid as subsidy directly to manufacturers.
25. **Neem Coated Urea (NCU)** was made **100% mandatory** for all indigenous and imported agricultural urea in **2015**; it prevents illegal diversion to chemical industries and improves Nitrogen Use Efficiency (NUE) by slowing degradation.
26. The **Nutrient Based Subsidy (NBS)** scheme was introduced on **1 April 2010** for non-urea P&K fertilizers (**DAP, MOP, Complex fertilizers**), where government fixes an annual per-kg subsidy based on nutrient content (N, P, K, S), while MRPs are decontrolled.
27. India is **100% import-dependent** for **Potassic fertilizers (Muriate of Potash - MOP)** as India has no commercially exploitable potash reserves.
28. The world's first commercial **Nano Liquid Urea** and **Nano DAP** plants were established by **IFFCO** at **Kalol, Gujarat**.
29. **PM-PRANAM** (PM Programme for Restoration, Awareness, Nourishment and Amelioration of Mother Earth) was announced in Union Budget 2023–24 to incentivise states to promote alternative fertilizers and reduce chemical fertilizer usage.
30. **Sikkim** was formally declared India's and the world's **First 100% Organic State** in **January 2016**; **Lakshadweep** is the first 100% Organic Union Territory (2020).
31. **Zero Budget Natural Farming (ZBNF)** was pioneered in India by Padma Shri **Subhash Palekar**; it relies on 4 core pillars: **Jeevamrutha** (microbial culture), **Bijamrutha** (seed treatment), **Acchadana** (mulching), and **Whapasa** (soil moisture aeration).
32. In institutional agricultural credit flow, **Commercial Banks** account for the overwhelming majority (**~75%–78%**), followed by **Regional Rural Banks (~12%–14%)** and **Cooperative Banks (~10%–12%)**.
33. Under the **Priority Sector Lending (PSL)** norms of the RBI, domestic scheduled commercial banks and foreign banks with ≥20 branches must allocate **18% of Adjusted Net Bank Credit (ANBC)** or Credit Equivalent of Off-Balance Sheet Exposure (CEOBE) to the **Agricultural sector** (with **10% specifically sub-targeted to Small and Marginal Farmers**).
34. The **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)** was established on **12 July 1982** under the NABARD Act, 1981, upon the recommendations of the **B. Sivaraman Committee (CRAFICARD)**, taking over the functions of the ACD and RPCC of RBI and the ARDC.
35. The **Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF)** was instituted within NABARD in **1995–96** to finance rural infrastructure projects of State Governments using the PSL shortfall of commercial banks.
36. The **Kisan Credit Card (KCC)** scheme was formulated by NABARD in **August 1998** on the recommendations of the **R.V. Gupta Committee** to provide timely, flexible short-term credit to farmers for crop production, post-harvest expenses, and working capital.
37. In 2018–19, the Government of India extended the **Kisan Credit Card (KCC) facility to Fisheries and Animal Husbandry farmers** to meet their working capital requirements.

38. The **Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)** was launched in **February 2016** (effective Kharif 2016), replacing NAIS and MNAIS; it charges a uniform low premium of **2.0% for Kharif crops**, **1.5% for Rabi crops**, and **5.0% for Annual Commercial & Horticultural crops**, with the balance actuarial premium subsidized 50:50 by the Centre and States.
39. The **Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP)** was established in **January 1965** (initially as the *Agricultural Prices Commission* until renamed in 1985); it functions as an advisory body under the Ministry of Agriculture.
40. The CACP recommends Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for **22 mandated agricultural crops** (14 Kharif, 6 Rabi, 2 commercial: Jute and Copra) and Fair & Remunerative Price (FRP) for **Sugarcane**; the final decision is taken by the **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)** chaired by the Prime Minister.
41. The **National Commission on Farmers (NCF)**, set up in 2004 under **Prof. M.S. Swaminathan**, recommended in its 5th report (2006) that the MSP should be fixed at least **50% above the comprehensive cost of production (Cost C2 + 50%)**.
42. The Central Government officially calculates the 1.5x MSP benchmark against the **Cost A2 + FL** formula (Paid-out costs + imputed family labor value), whereas farmer unions demand MSP based on the higher **Cost C2** (which also includes imputed land rent and interest on owned capital assets).
43. **Electronic National Agriculture Market (e-NAM)** was launched on **14 April 2016** as a pan-India electronic trading portal networking existing APMC mandis to create a unified national market for agricultural commodities; it is managed by the **Small Farmers' Agri-Business Consortium (SFAC)**.
44. The Central Sector Scheme for **Formation and Promotion of 10,000 Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs)** was launched in **2020** with a total budgetary outlay of ₹6,865 crore to achieve economies of scale for small and marginal farmers.
45. Under the **Model APMC Act 2003** and the **APLM Act 2017**, states are encouraged to allow private wholesale markets, direct purchase from farmers, establishment of e-trading platforms, and exemption of fruits and vegetables from mandi fees.
46. The **APEDA** (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority) was established by an Act of Parliament in **December 1985** under the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry** to promote export of agricultural and processed food products.
47. **MPEDA** (Marine Products Export Development Authority) was constituted in **1972** under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry to promote marine and seafood exports.
48. **Operation Flood (ऑपरेशन फ्लड)** was launched in **1970** by the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) under **Dr. Verghese Kurien** (Father of White Revolution in India), transforming India from a milk-deficient nation into the world's largest milk producer through the Anand cooperative pattern (AMUL).
49. In the **WTO Agreement on Agriculture (AoA)**, domestic agricultural subsidies are categorized into three color-coded boxes: **Green Box** (non-trade distorting, allowed without limit, e.g. R&D, pest control, environment), **Blue Box** (direct payments under production-limiting programs, allowed), and **Amber Box** (trade-distorting market price support and input subsidies, subject to reduction commitments).
50. Under WTO Amber Box rules, developing countries like India are entitled to a **de-minimis limit of 10%** of the total value of agricultural production; the **Peace Clause** agreed at the **Bali Ministerial Conference (2013)** protects India's food procurement programs under NFSA against legal challenges by developed nations even if the 10% ceiling is breached.

📋 Must-score facts — Crops, Seasons, Inputs, and Committees

Cropping Seasons in India (शस्य ऋतुएं)

Season	Sowing Period	Harvesting Period	Major Crops Grown	Climatic Requirements & Regional Spread
Kharif (खरीफ)	**June – July** (Onset of South-West Monsoon)	**September – October** (Autumn)	**Rice (धान), Maize (मक्का), Jowar, Bajra, Cotton, Jute, Groundnut, Soybean, Arhar/Tur, Urad, Moong**	High temperature, high humidity, abundant rainfall (100–200 cm). Pan-India coverage.
Rabi (रबी)	**October – November** (Onset of Winter)	**March – April** (Spring / Early Summer)	**Wheat (गेहूं), Barley (जौ), Gram (चना), Mustard (सरसों), Linseed (अलसी), Peas (मटर), Potato (आलू)**	Cool growing season, bright warm sunshine at ripening. Benefited by Western Disturbances in NW India.
Zaid (जायद)	**March – April** (Summer onset)	**May – June** (Pre-monsoon harvest)	**Watermelon, Muskmelon, Cucumber, Bitter gourd, Moong, Fodder crops**	Warm dry weather, continuous irrigation required. River basins and canal command tracts.

Landmark Committees in Agricultural Finance & Policy

Committee / Commission	Constituted Year	Key Mandate	Landmark Recommendation / Contribution
All-India Rural Credit Survey Committee (Gorwala)	**1951 (Report 1954)**	Rural credit structure review	Recommended creation of **State Bank of India (SBI)** by nationalizing Imperial Bank to spearhead rural banking.
B. Sivaraman Committee (CRAFICARD)	**1979 (Report 1981)**	Institutional credit arrangements for agriculture	Recommended creation of **NABARD (established 12 July 1982)** as apex rural refinancing institution.
R.V. Gupta Committee	**1997 (Report 1998)**	Simplification of agricultural credit delivery	Recommended formulation of the **Kisan Credit Card (KCC)** scheme (launched Aug 1998).
Prof. M.S. Swaminathan Committee (NCF)	**2004 (5 Reports, 2004–06)**	National Commission on Farmers	Recommended that MSP must be at least **Cost C2 + 50%**, asset protection, and farm credit interest rate cap at 4%.
Dr. Ashok Dalwai Committee	**2016 (Report 2018)**	Doubling Farmers' Income by 2022	Recommended shift from "production-centric" to "income-centric" agriculture, promoting FPOs, secondary agri, e-NAM.

Topic 6 — Agricultural Policies, Schemes, MSP and Revolutions

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. The **Green Revolution** (from about **1966–69**) brought semi-dwarf High Yielding Variety (HYV) wheat developed by **Dr. Norman Borlaug** at CIMMYT, Mexico.
2. In India the Green Revolution was pioneered by **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan** with Union Agriculture Minister **C. Subramaniam**.
3. The first wave concentrated on **wheat and rice** in **Punjab, Haryana, and Western Uttar Pradesh**.
4. Key early wheat lines included **Lerma Rojo 64A**, **Sonora 64**, and Indian derivatives **Kalyan Sona** and **Sonalika**.
5. The rice variety **IR-8** ("Miracle Rice") came from IRRI (Philippines) and entered India around **1966**.
6. Green Revolution success rested on three pillars: **HYV seeds**, **chemical fertilizers**, and **assured irrigation**.
7. Later critiques stressed regional bias, crop bias toward wheat–rice, class inequality, groundwater stress, and chemical dependency.
8. The **Evergreen Revolution** idea, coined by **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan**, means productivity growth without ecological harm.
9. **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan** was awarded the **Bharat Ratna** in **2024** (posthumous).
10. The **White Revolution** is the dairy/milk drive led by **Dr. Verghese Kurien** ("Milkman of India").
11. **Operation Flood** was launched in **1970** by the **National Dairy Development Board (NDDB)** on the Amul cooperative model.
12. **NDDB** was established in **1965** at **Anand, Gujarat** — five years before Operation Flood.
13. Operation Flood Phase I (**1970–81**) used sale proceeds of European Community donated milk powder and butter oil to link the Anand pattern with major metro milk sheds.
14. Phase II (**1981–85**) expanded milk sheds and urban markets; Phase III (**1985–96**) consolidated the National Dairy Grid.
15. India became the **world's largest milk producer** through this cooperative dairy grid.
16. The **Yellow Revolution** is the oilseeds surge (mustard, sunflower, groundnut) under the **Technology Mission on Oilseeds (1986)** associated with **Sam Pitroda**.
17. The **Blue Revolution** covers fisheries and aquaculture; pioneers include **Dr. Hiralal Chaudhuri** and **Dr. Arun Krishnan**.
18. The **Golden Revolution** covers horticulture, honey, and fruits (**1991–2003**), associated with **Nirpakh Tutej**.
19. The **Golden Fibre Revolution** is **jute**; the **Silver Fibre Revolution** is **cotton**.
20. The **Silver Revolution** is eggs and poultry expansion, promoted in the Indira Gandhi era.
21. The **Pink Revolution** covers onion, pharmaceuticals, and meat/prawn exports, associated with **Durgesh Patel**.
22. The **Red Revolution** covers meat and tomato production, associated with **Vishal Tewari**.
23. The **Grey Revolution** is chemical fertilizer expansion; the **Round Revolution** is potato (CPRI, **Kufri, Shimla**).
24. The **Rainbow Revolution** is the umbrella push for simultaneous growth of crops, livestock, forestry, and fisheries (National Agriculture Policy, 2000).
25. The **Sweet Revolution** is beekeeping and honey (National Beekeeping & Honey Mission) — not sugarcane.
26. The **Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP)** began in **January 1965** as the Agricultural Prices Commission and was renamed CACP in **1985**.
27. CACP is an **advisory** body under the Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare; it recommends MSP in Price Policy Reports.
28. Final MSP approval is taken by the **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)** chaired by the Prime Minister.
29. CACP recommends MSP for **22 mandated crops**: **7 cereals**, **5 pulses**, **7 oilseeds**, and **3 commercial crops**.
30. The **7 cereals** are paddy, wheat, maize, jowar, bajra, ragi, and barley.

31. The **5 pulses** are gram, tur/arhar, moong, urad, and lentil (masur).
32. The **7 oilseeds** are groundnut, rapeseed/mustard, soybean, sesamum, sunflower, safflower, and nigerseed.
33. The **3 commercial crops** are copra, raw cotton, and raw jute.
34. **Palm oil** is not among the 22 MSP crops; it uses a **Viability Price** under NMEO-OP.
35. **Cost A_2** covers paid-out cash and kind costs (seed, fertilizer, pesticide, hired labour, fuel, irrigation, lease rent for leased-in land).
36. **Cost A_2 + FL** equals A_2 plus the **imputed value of unpaid family labour**.
37. **Cost C_2** equals A_2 + FL plus **imputed rent of owned land** and **interest on owned fixed capital** (excluding land).
38. The Swaminathan National Commission on Farmers (**2006**) recommended MSP at least **C_2 + 50%**.
39. From Union Budget **2018–19**, the Government's stated MSP benchmark is at least **1.5 × (A_2 + FL)** for mandated crops.
40. **Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP)** is the statutory floor for **sugarcane** under the **Sugarcane (Control) Order, 1966**, on CACP advice.
41. FRP is linked to a basic sugar recovery rate (commonly cited around **10.25%**), with a premium for higher recovery.
42. **State Advised Price (SAP)** is announced by some States (notably UP, Haryana, Punjab) and is typically **higher than FRP**.
43. Uttar Pradesh accounts for roughly **45%–50%** of India's sugarcane and has the densest sugar-mill belt; SAP there is binding on mills.
44. The **Food Corporation of India (FCI)** was set up under the Food Corporations Act, **1964**, and began work on **14 January 1965** (first office Thanjavur; HQ New Delhi).
45. FCI's core mandates are price support procurement, TPDS distribution, and buffer/operational stocks for national food security.
46. **Economic cost** of foodgrain to FCI = pooled acquisition cost (MSP) + procurement incidentals + distribution cost.
47. **Food subsidy** ≈ economic cost − **Central Issue Price (CIP)**.
48. **Open Market Sale Scheme (OMSS)** lets FCI sell surplus wheat/rice by e-auction to cool open-market prices.
49. Buffer stock norms fix minimum FCI inventories at the start of each quarter (**1 Jan, 1 Apr, 1 Jul, 1 Oct**).
50. FCI mainly procures **wheat and rice**; pulses and oilseeds under Price Support Scheme are largely handled by **NAFED / NCCF**.

📋 Must-score facts — Revolutions matrix & 22 MSP crops

Table 1 — Agricultural revolutions & proponents

Revolution	Commodity / sector	Pioneer / key personality	Landmark
Green	Wheat and rice	Norman Borlaug (world) / M.S. Swaminathan (India)	HYV semi-dwarf seeds; Punjab–Haryana–Western UP
White	Milk and dairy	Verghese Kurien	Operation Flood (1970); Amul / NDDB
Yellow	Oilseeds	Sam Pitroda	Technology Mission on Oilseeds (1986)
Blue	Fisheries / aquaculture	Hiralal Chaudhuri & Arun Krishnan	Neel Kranti; PMMSY
Golden	Horticulture, honey, fruits	Nirpakh Tutej	MIDH; Honey Mission
Golden Fibre	Jute	—	National Jute Board
Silver	Eggs / poultry	Indira Gandhi era push	Commercial poultry; NECC
Silver Fibre	Cotton	—	Bt cotton; Technology Mission on Cotton

Revolution	Commodity / sector	Pioneer / key personality	Landmark
Pink	Onion, prawns, pharma	Durgesh Patel	Meat / shrimp processing
Red	Meat and tomato	Vishal Tewari	Processing / abattoirs
Grey	Fertilizers	—	Urea / DAP capacity
Round	Potato	—	CPRI, Kufri (Shimla)
Evergreen	Sustainable agriculture	M.S. Swaminathan	Ecology + productivity
Rainbow	Holistic agri integration	National Agri Policy 2000	Crops + livestock + forestry + fishery
Sweet	Beekeeping / honey	—	National Beekeeping & Honey Mission

Table 2 — 22 mandated MSP crops + sugarcane FRP

Group	Count	Crops	Notes
Cereals	**7**	Paddy, Wheat, Maize, Jowar, Bajra, Ragi, Barley	CACP recommends; CCEA approves; paddy & wheat dominate physical procurement
Pulses	**5**	Gram, Tur/Arhar, Moong, Urad, Lentil (Masur)	Often via NAFED/NCCF under PSS
Oilseeds	**7**	Groundnut, Rapeseed/Mustard, Soybean, Sesamum, Sunflower, Safflower, Nigerseed	Edible-oil self-reliance push
Commercial	**3**	Copra, Raw Cotton, Raw Jute	CCI (cotton); Jute Corporation (jute)
Special	**1**	**Sugarcane**	**FRP** under Sugarcane (Control) Order, 1966 — not MSP

```
CACP COST LADDER (decidable spine)
──────────────────────────────────

A₂          = paid-out costs (seed, fertilizer, hired labour, lease rent…)
A₂ + FL     = A₂ + unpaid family labour
            → Government MSP benchmark: ≥ 1.5 × (A₂ + FL)
C₂          = A₂ + FL + owned-land rent + interest on fixed capital
            → Swaminathan recommendation: C₂ + 50%  (not the current fixing rule)
```

Topic 7 — Industry, MSME and Infrastructure

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. In national income accounting, the **secondary sector** comprises manufacturing, electricity, gas, water supply, and construction.
2. **Industrialisation** represents the structural transition of an economy characterized by an expanding share of manufacturing in aggregate Gross Value Added (GVA) and total employment, fostering technological accumulation and domestic capital goods production.
3. India's industrial policy evolved through distinct historical phases: the **Industrial Policy Resolution (IPR) of 1948** (first policy of independent India establishing a mixed economy); the **IPR of 1956** (the "Economic Constitution of India" prioritizing state-led heavy industry); and the **New Industrial Policy of 24 July 1991** (dismantling the License-Permit-Quota Raj).
4. Enterprises are structurally differentiated: **large-scale industries** employ organized labor and heavy capital equipment, whereas **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)** and **cottage industries** are more labor-absorptive, decentralized, and capital-light.
5. **Cottage industries** are household-based, artisan-operated productive activities utilizing traditional indigenous tools, where workplace and domestic dwelling are largely identical.
6. The landmark MSME definition implemented on **1 July 2020** introduced a **composite criterion combining investment and annual turnover**, completely erasing the historical dichotomy between manufacturing and service enterprises.
7. **2020 Composite MSME Classification:** - **Micro Enterprise:** Investment in Plant & Machinery/Equipment ≤ **₹1 crore** and Annual Turnover ≤ **₹5 crore**. - **Small Enterprise:** Investment ≤ **₹10 crore** and Annual Turnover ≤ **₹50 crore**. - **Medium Enterprise:** Investment ≤ **₹50 crore** and Annual Turnover ≤ **₹250 crore**.
8. **Revised Thresholds (Effective 1 April 2025):** The Union Government revised thresholds upward by 2.5x for investment and 2x for turnover:

- **Micro:** Investment ≤ **₹2.5 crore** and Turnover ≤ **₹10 crore**.
- **Small:** Investment ≤ **₹25 crore** and Turnover ≤ **₹100 crore**.
- **Medium:** Investment ≤ **₹125 crore** and Turnover ≤ **₹500 crore**. 9. MSMEs contribute approximately **30% of India's GDP**, over **45% of total manufacturing output**, and nearly **40% of national merchandise exports**, employing over 110 million citizens. All bank lending to eligible MSMEs counts toward **Priority Sector Lending (PSL)** targets. 10. The **Karve Committee (Village and Small-Scale Industries Committee, 1955)** was appointed during the Second Five-Year Plan to assess the developmental potential of small industries in absorbing surplus rural labour. 11. The **Nayak Committee (1991)** examined institutional credit bottlenecks facing small-scale industries and recommended that working capital credit should represent at least 20% of projected annual turnover. 12. The **Abid Hussain Committee (1997)** recommended the phased dismantling and abolition of policy reservations that restricted specific product manufacturing exclusively to the small-scale sector. 13. The **S.S. Kohli Committee (2000)** was constituted by the Reserve Bank of India to formulate rehabilitation parameters for sick small-scale industrial units. 14. The **Make in India** initiative was launched on **25 September 2014** by Prime Minister Narendra Modi to facilitate foreign investment, foster innovation, enhance skill development, and transform India into a global manufacturing hub. Its iconic symbol is a **lion made of mechanical cogs**. 15. The **Startup India** initiative was launched on **16 January 2016** to nurture an entrepreneurship ecosystem through simplified regulatory compliance, tax exemptions, and institutional venture capital funding. 16. The **Stand-Up India Scheme** was launched on **5 April 2016** to facilitate bank loans between **₹10 lakh and ₹1 crore** to at least one Scheduled Caste (SC) or Scheduled Tribe (ST) borrower and at least one woman borrower per bank branch for setting up greenfield (new) enterprises in manufacturing, services, or trading. 17. The **Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY)** was launched on **8 April 2015** to provide non-corporate, non-farm micro-enterprises with collateral-free loans up to ₹10 lakh across three categories: **Shishu**

(up to ₹50,000), **Kishore** (₹50,001 to ₹5 lakh), and **Tarun** (₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh). In October 2024, the government expanded the framework to include **Tarun Plus** (up to **₹20 lakh**) for borrowers who successfully repaid earlier Tarun loans. 18. Special Economic Zones (SEZs) provide duty-free enclaves treated as foreign territory for tariff purposes to boost exports and attract foreign direct investment. Asia's first Export Processing Zone (EPZ) was established at **Kandla, Gujarat in 1965**. 19. Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs) are granted graded operational, financial, and investment autonomy:

- **Maharatna:** CPSEs with average annual net profit over ₹5,000 crore, net worth of ₹15,000 crore, and turnover of ₹25,000 crore over three years (authorized to make equity investments up to ₹5,000 crore without prior government sanction).
- **Navratna:** Authorized to invest up to ₹1,000 crore without prior central approval.
- **Miniratna (Category I & II):** Graded investment powers up to ₹500 crore. 20. **Disinvestment** involves the partial sale of government equity holdings in public sector enterprises without relinquishing operational management control. In contrast, **Strategic Disinvestment / Privatization** entails transferring at least 50% equity along with management control to a private strategic buyer. 21. Disinvestment proceeds flow into the **National Investment Fund (NIF)**, instituted in 2005, where capital is deployed to capitalize social sector projects and revive viable CPSEs. 22. **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** involves cross-border investment wherein an overseas investor acquires a lasting management interest (statutorily defined in India as 10% or more of the equity share capital) in an Indian enterprise. 23. The **Services Sector** (encompassing financial, banking, insurance, IT, and outsourcing activities) represents the single largest cumulative recipient of FDI equity inflows into India. 24. **Singapore** and **Mauritius** historically represent the top source countries for foreign direct investment into India. 25. The **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)** measures short-term volume growth in industrial production; it comprises three broad categories: **Manufacturing (weight 77.63%)**, **Mining (14.37%)**, and **Electricity (7.99%)**. Construction, agriculture, gas, and water supply are **not included** in the IIP. 26. The **Eight Core Industries** represent foundational infrastructure sectors comprising **40.27% of the total weight of the IIP**. 27. The Eight Core Industries and their approximate weights are:

1. **Refinery Products** (28.04% - highest weight)
2. **Electricity** (19.85%)
3. **Steel** (17.92%)
4. **Coal** (10.33%)
5. **Crude Oil** (8.98%)
6. **Natural Gas** (6.88%)
7. **Cement** (5.37%)
8. **Fertilizers** (2.63% - lowest weight) *(Note: Chemicals, textiles, and automobiles are NOT among the Eight Core Industries)*.
9. The **Textile Industry** is India's oldest organized manufacturing industry and the second-largest employment provider after agriculture. Within cloth production, the **powerloom sector** produces the vast majority of fabric, far surpassing organized mill-made and handloom production.
10. The modern Indian cotton textile mill industry originated in **1854** when Cowasjee Nanabhoy Davar established the Bombay Spinning and Weaving Mill (following an earlier unsuccessful venture at Fort Gloster, Bengal in 1818).
11. The Second Five-Year Plan established landmark integrated public-sector steel plants through bilateral foreign technical collaborations:

- **Bhilai Steel Plant (Chhattisgarh):** Collaboration with the **USSR** (1955)
- **Rourkela Steel Plant (Odisha):** Collaboration with **West Germany** (Krupp and Demag, 1959)
- **Durgapur Steel Plant (West Bengal):** Collaboration with the **United Kingdom** (1959)
- **Bokaro Steel Plant (Jharkhand, Third Plan):** Collaboration with the **USSR** (1964) 31. India is the **second-largest crude steel producer** in the world, surpassed only by China. 32. India is the **second-largest cement producer** in

the world, following China, with cement manufacturing concentrated near extensive limestone belts in Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Madhya Pradesh. 33. India's **pharmaceutical industry** is globally ranked **3rd by volume** and 14th by value, earning recognition as the "Pharmacy of the World" due to its dominant share in affordable generic formulations and global vaccine supply. 34. India has emerged as the **second-largest manufacturer of mobile phones** globally in volume terms, driven by phased manufacturing programs and production-linked incentives. 35. The **National Manufacturing Policy (NMP)** was notified on **4 November 2011**, establishing the ambitious objective of raising manufacturing's share of GDP to **25%** and creating **100 million additional jobs** through large-scale **National Investment and Manufacturing Zones (NIMZs)**. 36. The **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Schemes** provide financial incentives on incremental domestic sales over a base year to attract large-scale capital investments across 14 designated strategic sectors (including electronics, pharmaceuticals, telecom, automobiles, and advanced chemistry cell batteries). 37. **PM Gati Shakti – National Master Plan for Multi-modal Connectivity** was launched on **13 October 2021** by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. It is a GIS-enabled digital platform that synchronizes multi-modal project execution across 16 infrastructure ministries to eliminate bureaucratic silos and lower national logistics costs. 38. PM Gati Shakti is driven by **Seven Strategic Engines**: **Roads, Railways, Airports, Ports, Mass Transport, Waterways, and Logistics Infrastructure**. 39. The **National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP)** covers a planned capital investment horizon of **FY 2020–2025** across economic and social infrastructure projects, with funding shared in the ratio: **39% Centre, 39% States, and 22% Private Sector**. 40. **Bharatmala Pariyojana** is an umbrella highway development program launched by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways to optimize economic corridors, border connectivity, coastal roads, and multi-modal logistics parks. 41. **Sagarmala Programme** is a flagship initiative of the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways aimed at port-led industrialization, coastal community development, port modernization, and coastal shipping connectivity. 42. The **Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC)** project comprises dedicated railway corridors—the **Western DFC** (Dadri, UP to JNPT, Mumbai) and the **Eastern DFC** (Ludhiana, Punjab to Dankuni, West Bengal)—engineered exclusively for heavy freight transit. 43. The **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** was established in **2015** as a sovereign-linked alternative asset management platform under the Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, with an initial targeted corpus of **₹40,000 crore**. It is not an attached organ of NITI Aayog. 44. The **Deepak Parekh Committee** submitted recommendations on infrastructure financing, while the **Dr. Vijay Kelkar Committee (2015)** formulated policy blueprints for revitalizing and restructuring Public-Private Partnership (PPP) infrastructure contracts. 45. Indian Railways has committed to achieving **100% broad-gauge rail electrification** and attaining the target of becoming a **Net Zero Carbon Emitter by 2030**. 46. The **Delhi–Mumbai Industrial Corridor (DMIC)** is India's premier greenfield industrial corridor, developed along the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor in technical and financial collaboration with the Government of **Japan**. 47. **CGTMSE (Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises)** was established jointly by the Ministry of MSME and the **Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)** to provide collateral-free credit guarantees to financial institutions lending to MSMEs. 48. The **Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB)** was constituted under the *PNGRB Act, 2006* to regulate downstream refining, transportation, distribution, and marketing of petroleum and natural gas; legal appeals against PNGRB orders lie before the **Appellate Tribunal for Electricity (APTEL)**. 49. **Petroleum Conservation Research Association (PCRA)** is a registered society under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas engaged in promoting fuel efficiency and conservation practices. 50. **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)** was the first private-sector Indian commercial enterprise to feature on the global *Fortune Global 500* ranking (in 2006) and the first Indian corporation to surpass USD 200 billion in market capitalization.

📋 Must-Score Drill — Manufacturing, MSME, and Infrastructure

Industrial Policy or Infrastructure Program	Core Milestone / Structural Fact
Make in India Launch Date	25 September 2014; symbol is a lion made of cogs
PM Gati Shakti Launch Date & Engines	13 October 2021; seven strategic transport and logistics engines
First Export Processing Zone (EPZ)	Kandla, Gujarat (1965); Asia's first EPZ

Industrial Policy or Infrastructure Program	Core Milestone / Structural Fact
Micro Enterprise Criteria (2020)	Investment ≤ ₹1 crore and Turnover ≤ ₹5 crore
Small Enterprise Criteria (2020)	Investment ≤ ₹10 crore and Turnover ≤ ₹50 crore
Medium Enterprise Criteria (2020)	Investment ≤ ₹50 crore and Turnover ≤ ₹250 crore
Karve Committee Year & Domain	1955; Village and Small-Scale Industries
Nayak Committee Year & Domain	1991; Credit bottlenecks and working capital for SSIs
Abid Hussain Committee Year & Domain	1997; Recommended abolition of SSI product reservation
S.S. Kohli Committee Year & Domain	2000; Rehabilitation of sick SSI units
Top FDI Source Country (2023–24)	Singapore
Top Sector for FDI Inflows	Services Sector (financial, banking, IT, business services)
IIP Sectors & Weights	Manufacturing (77.63%), Mining (14.37%), Electricity (7.99%)
Heaviest Core Industry by Weight	Petroleum Refinery Products (28.04% of Eight Core Industries)
Bhilai Steel Plant Partner	USSR / Russia (1955)
Rourkela Steel Plant Partner	West Germany (Krupp and Demag, 1959)
Durgapur Steel Plant Partner	United Kingdom (1959)
Bokaro Steel Plant Partner	USSR / Russia (1964)
National Manufacturing Policy Goal	2011; Target 25% GDP share and 100 million manufacturing jobs
National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP)	FY 2020–2025; Funding ratio 39% Centre, 39% States, 22% Private
NIIF Corpus & Setup Year	2015; Initial corpus ₹40,000 crore under Department of Economic Affairs
Indian Railways Net Zero Target	Target year 2030; 100% electrification of broad-gauge network
Delhi–Mumbai Industrial Corridor (DMIC)	Technical and financial collaboration with Japan

Topic 8 — Employment, Poverty, Human Capital and Social Economy

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **Poverty** is defined as the inability of an individual or household to secure a socially acceptable minimum standard of living, measured through consumption expenditure lines or multidimensional deprivations.
2. Official poverty estimation in India has historically relied on **household consumer expenditure surveys (CES)** conducted by the NSSO/NSO, rather than reported per capita income.
3. The **Alagh Committee (Task Force, 1979)** established India's first official nutritional poverty line based strictly on minimum daily calorie requirements.
4. The calorie benchmarks established by the Alagh Task Force were **2,400 kcal per person per day in rural areas** and **2,100 kcal per person per day in urban areas**.
5. Subsequent official committees on poverty estimation include the **Lakdawala Committee (1993)**, **Tendulkar Committee (2009)**, and **Rangarajan Committee (2014)**.
6. The **Head Count Ratio (HCR)** measures the proportion or percentage of the total population living below the designated poverty line.
7. **Dadabhai Naoroji** computed the first historical poverty line in India by calculating the **jail cost of living** for prisoners and adjusting for children and women.
8. Core social indicators of poverty include **illiteracy, infant malnutrition, lack of access to safe drinking water, poor sanitation, and absence of gainful employment**.
9. **Size of house (floor area)** is not a recognized social indicator of poverty; poverty assessments evaluate structural housing quality and roofing/flooring materials rather than square footage.
10. The **Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI)** was launched in the **2010 Human Development Report** by UNDP and OPHI, superseding the **Human Poverty Index (HPI)** introduced in 1997.
11. The global MPI evaluates deprivations across three equally weighted dimensions: **Health**, **Education**, and **Standard of Living**, assessed through ten indicators.
12. The MPI is a **non-monetary** deprivation metric; it does not measure monetary poverty such as the World Bank's international extreme poverty line (USD 2.15/day).
13. **NITI Aayog** publishes the **National Multidimensional Poverty Index (National MPI)** using National Family Health Survey (NFHS) data, adding antenatal care and bank accounts as Indian indicators.
14. **MGNREGA (2005)** provides a statutory legal guarantee of **100 days of wage employment per financial year to every rural household** whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work.
15. **Unemployment** occurs when individuals who are able and willing to work at the prevailing wage rate are unable to find gainful employment.
16. **Disguised unemployment** refers to a situation where more workers are engaged in an activity than necessary, such that the marginal productivity of surplus labor is zero or near zero (prevalent in Indian agriculture).
17. **Seasonal unemployment** occurs when workers remain unemployed during specific periods of the year when agricultural or tourism activity ceases.
18. **Structural unemployment** arises from a fundamental mismatch between the skills possessed by available workers and the skills demanded by emerging economic sectors.
19. **Frictional unemployment** is temporary, transitional unemployment occurring while workers search for or transition between jobs.
20. **Cyclical unemployment** results from general economic downturns and inadequate aggregate demand in the business cycle.
21. The **Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR)** measures the percentage of the working-age population that is either employed or actively seeking employment.
22. The **informal sector** accounts for over 80% of total employment in India, characterized by lack of social security benefits, written contracts, and job security.

23. **Human capital** represents the aggregate stock of knowledge, skills, competencies, and physical health embodied in an economy's workforce.
24. Investments in education, vocational training, and public healthcare generate compounding economic returns by raising labor productivity and driving technological adoption.
25. The **Human Development Index (HDI)**, published annually by the UNDP since **1990**, evaluates human progress across three fundamental dimensions: a long and healthy life, knowledge, and a decent standard of living.
26. The specific indicators utilized in computing the HDI are **life expectancy at birth**, **mean years of schooling**, **expected years of schooling**, and **Gross National Income (GNI) per capita (in PPP USD)**.
27. **Mahbub ul Haq** pioneered the design and publication of the Human Development Index, with intellectual foundation drawn from **Amartya Sen's Capability Approach**.
28. The **demographic dividend** refers to the economic growth potential created when the proportion of the working-age population (**15–59 years** in Indian demographic classification) exceeds the dependent population (children and elderly).
29. **Inclusive growth** ensures that economic expansion generates broad-based opportunities and equitable sharing of wealth across regions, social strata, and genders.
30. The UNDP publishes complementary indices alongside HDI, including the **Inequality-adjusted HDI (IHDI)**, **Gender Development Index (GDI)**, and **Gender Inequality Index (GII)** (introduced in HDR 2010).
31. The **Brundtland Commission Report (*Our Common Future*, 1987)** defined sustainable development as development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.
32. The concept of sustainable development first received international policy mention in the **IUCN World Conservation Strategy (1980)** and was formalized at the Rio Earth Summit via **Agenda 21 (1992)**.
33. **Social capital** refers to mutual trust, civic networks, and shared norms that facilitate social cooperation; it is distinct from human capital (individual skills and health) and physical capital (machinery and infrastructure).
34. Investments in irrigation, power grids, or roads create physical infrastructure, whereas investments in schools, universities, and hospitals directly form human capital.
35. French sociologist **Auguste Comte** formulated the **Law of Three Stages** of social evolution: the theological stage, metaphysical stage, and positive or scientific stage.
36. The historical evolution of development indicators progressed chronologically from **Per Capita Income (PCI)** → **Physical Quality of Life Index (PQLI, 1970s)** → **Human Development Index (HDI, 1990)**.
37. The **Physical Quality of Life Index (PQLI)** was devised by **Morris D. Morris** in the mid-1970s, averaging three non-monetary indicators: basic literacy, infant mortality rate, and life expectancy at age one.
38. **Amartya Sen's Capability Approach** conceptualizes poverty as the deprivation of basic capabilities and freedoms, viewing economic development as the expansion of human substantive choices.
39. In the post-2010 HDI calculation methodology, the fixed goalposts for the Life Expectancy Index are set between a minimum of **20 years** and a maximum of **85 years**.
40. In the pre-2010 HDI methodology, standard of living was measured by **GDP per capita (PPP USD)**; since 2010, the UNDP utilizes **GNI per capita (PPP USD)** to better capture cross-border income flows.
41. The **Gender Inequality Index (GII)**, introduced in HDR 2010, evaluates gender disparities across three dimensions: reproductive health (MMR and adolescent birth rate), empowerment (parliamentary share and secondary education), and labor market participation.
42. **Bhutan** introduced the concept of **Gross National Happiness (GNH)** in 1972, grounded in four pillars: sustainable socio-economic development, environmental conservation, preservation of culture, and good governance.
43. The **World Happiness Report**, released by the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN), measures subjective life evaluations based on Gallup World Poll data, separate from the composite capability framework of the HDI.
44. **Madhya Pradesh** was the first State in India to publish a State Human Development Report in **1995**.

45. In national Human Development rankings, **Kerala** consistently ranks highest among Indian States, while **Bihar** and **Uttar Pradesh** have historically occupied lower tiers due to educational and health deficits.
46. The **Bare Necessities Index (BNI)**, presented in the Economic Survey 2020–21, tracks basic living amenities across **26 indicators** grouped into **five dimensions**: water, sanitation, housing, micro-environment, and other facilities (for 2012 and 2018).
47. Empirical correlation shows that States performing high on the NITI Aayog SDG India Index also achieve superior HDI scores, driven by improvements in public healthcare and schooling infrastructure.
48. Sustainable development principles are rooted in environmental **carrying capacity**, requiring that economic resource extraction not exceed regeneration rates and waste discharge not exceed assimilative capacity.
49. Structural causes of persistent poverty in India include low agricultural productivity, underemployment, unequal asset distribution, social stratification, and catastrophic out-of-pocket health expenditures.
50. Effective poverty eradication requires a synergistic strategy combining sustained labor-intensive economic growth, targeted social protection nets, direct welfare transfers, and universal human capital development.

Topic 9 — External Sector, Foreign Trade and Global Economy

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **Foreign trade** comprises the cross-border exchange of goods, services, and capital resources; exports generate foreign exchange receipts, whereas imports represent foreign exchange expenditures.
2. The **Balance of Trade (BoT)** measures the net difference between the monetary value of merchandise exports and merchandise imports, capturing physical goods exclusively.
3. A **trade surplus** occurs when the value of visible goods exports exceeds visible imports; a **trade deficit** occurs when merchandise imports exceed exports.
4. The **Balance of Payments (BoP)** is a comprehensive, double-entry statistical statement summarizing all economic transactions between residents of a country and the rest of the world over a designated accounting period.
5. In economic accounting, the BoP is bifurcated into two primary accounts: the **Current Account** and the **Capital Account** (alongside errors, omissions, and foreign exchange reserve changes).
6. The **Current Account** records transactions in physical goods (merchandise), invisible trade (commercial services), primary income (investment earnings, interest, and dividends), and secondary income (unrequited transfers such as remittances and grants).
7. The **export and import of visible goods** is recorded strictly on the **Current Account** of the Balance of Payments.
8. Capital transfers, **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)**, **Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI)**, **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)**, and **IMF loans** are recorded exclusively on the **Capital Account**.
9. The **trade deficit** reflects only the shortfall in visible merchandise trade, whereas the **Current Account Deficit (CAD)** reflects the broader net balance across goods, services, income, and transfers combined.
10. India consistently runs a structural **merchandise trade deficit**, which is partially counterbalanced by a structural surplus in **invisible services exports (IT/BPO)** and **private remittances**.
11. **Invisible trade** encompasses non-merchandise external earnings, including computer software services, business consulting, international tourism, transportation, and intellectual property royalties.
12. **Inward remittances** are private transfers sent by overseas non-resident workers to their home countries, classified as secondary income credits on the current account.
13. India has consistently ranked as the **largest global recipient of remittances**, receiving over USD 110 billion annually according to World Bank Migration and Development Briefs.
14. The **Capital Account** records all international asset transactions that alter the external asset or liability status of a nation's residents or sovereign government.
15. **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** represents a lasting foreign capital investment wherein the overseas investor acquires a significant degree of management influence or ownership control (conventionally defined as 10% or more of voting equity).
16. **Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI)** represents passive investments in financial securities such as equities, corporate bonds, and government securities without acquiring active managerial control.
17. FPI flows are highly liquid and sensitive to global risk sentiment and interest rate differentials, earning them the moniker "hot money."
18. **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)** are commercial loans in foreign currencies raised by Indian corporate entities from non-resident lenders, regulated under RBI guidelines.
19. India's **external debt** comprises sovereign debt, commercial borrowings, NRI deposits, and short-term trade credits; the **US dollar** constitutes the largest denominating currency of India's external debt (over 50%).
20. **Foreign exchange reserves** held by the Reserve Bank of India comprise four distinct asset classes: **Foreign Currency Assets (FCA)**, **Gold**, **Special Drawing Rights (SDRs)**, and the **Reserve Tranche Position (RTP)** in the IMF.

21. Foreign exchange reserves provide crucial **import cover** (the number of months of imports a nation's reserves can finance) and enable the central bank to mitigate excessive domestic currency volatility.
22. The **nominal exchange rate** denotes the price of one unit of domestic currency expressed in terms of a foreign currency (or vice versa).
23. In a **flexible (floating) exchange rate regime**, the external market value of the national currency is determined organically by the interplay of market demand and supply of foreign exchange in international currency markets.
24. In a pure floating regime, market demand and supply arise from real trade flows, private capital transfers, portfolio investments, and commercial activities—they are **not determined by the central bank**.
25. India adheres to a **managed float exchange rate regime** (also called a "dirty float"), wherein the market sets the currency trajectory, but the RBI intervenes through open market forex operations to prevent speculative shocks.
26. In a **fixed (pegged) exchange rate regime**, the government or central bank officially fixes the currency value against a single anchor currency or basket of currencies and intervenes to maintain that parity.
27. **Currency depreciation** refers to a decrease in the market value of a domestic currency relative to foreign currencies under a floating exchange rate mechanism.
28. **Currency appreciation** refers to an increase in the market value of a domestic currency relative to foreign currencies under a floating exchange rate mechanism.
29. **Currency devaluation** represents a deliberate, official downward adjustment of a nation's currency value by monetary authorities under a fixed or pegged exchange rate system.
30. **Currency revaluation** represents a deliberate, official upward adjustment of a nation's currency value by monetary authorities under a fixed exchange rate system.
31. Currency depreciation or devaluation makes domestic exports relatively **cheaper and more competitive** in foreign markets, while rendering imported foreign goods more **expensive** in domestic currency.
32. The **Marshall-Lerner Condition** establishes that currency devaluation or depreciation will improve a nation's trade balance only if the sum of price elasticities of demand for exports and imports exceeds unity ($|e_x + e_m| > 1$).
33. The **J-Curve Effect** demonstrates that following a currency devaluation, the trade balance often deteriorates in the short run due to pre-existing import contracts before improving over the medium term.
34. The **Nominal Effective Exchange Rate (NEER)** is an unadjusted weighted average value of a currency relative to an index of trading partner currencies.
35. The **Real Effective Exchange Rate (REER)** is the NEER adjusted for inflation differentials between the domestic economy and its major trading partners; a rising REER signifies an erosion of trade competitiveness.
36. **Currency convertibility** denotes the legal freedom to convert domestic currency into foreign currencies (and vice versa) at market-determined rates without official rationing or administrative restrictions.
37. India achieved **full current account convertibility** in **August 1994** by accepting the obligations of Article VIII of the IMF Articles of Agreement.
38. **Capital Account Convertibility (CAC)** permits unrestricted conversion of local financial assets into foreign financial assets at market rates; India maintains a gradual, calibrated approach toward capital account liberalization.
39. The **Tarapore Committees on Capital Account Convertibility (1997 and 2006)** outlined strict macroeconomic preconditions for full CAC, including fiscal consolidation, low inflation, gross NPA reduction, and adequate foreign exchange reserves.
40. The **Foreign Exchange Regulation Act (FERA, 1973)** was enacted during a period of acute foreign exchange shortages, treating foreign exchange contraventions with severe penal and criminal sanctions.
41. The **Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA, 1999)** was enacted in **1999** to replace FERA, officially taking effect on **1 June 2000**; it transformed foreign exchange violations into civil offenses adjudicated through monetary penalties.
42. FEMA is administered primarily by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, while investigation of civil contraventions is handled by the **Directorate of Enforcement (ED)**.

43. **Tariffs** are customs duties or taxes levied on physical goods when they cross international national frontiers, increasing the domestic price of imported products.
44. **Non-Tariff Barriers (NTBs)** include regulatory trade restrictions such as import quotas, voluntary export restraints, licensing requirements, rules of origin, and stringent Sanitary and Phytosanitary (SPS) measures.
45. The **World Trade Organization (WTO)** was established on **1 January 1995** under the Marrakesh Agreement, superseding the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT, 1947).
46. The WTO is headquartered in **Geneva, Switzerland**; its current membership stands at **166 nations** (with Comoros and Timor-Leste joining in 2024), led by Director-General **Dr. Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala**; it operates a legally binding **Dispute Settlement Body (DSB)**.
47. The WTO's supreme decision-making body is the **Ministerial Conference**, convening at least once every two years: landmark recent conferences include MC-12 in Geneva (2022), **MC-13 in Abu Dhabi, UAE (February 2024)**, and the upcoming **MC-14 in Yaoundé, Cameroon (2026)** — only the second WTO Ministerial Conference in history to be held on African soil (following Nairobi in 2015).
48. India's **Foreign Trade Policy (FTP 2023)** replaced traditional incentive-driven export subsidy programs with remission-based frameworks (e.g., RoDTEP and RoSCTL), targeting **USD 2 trillion in total exports by 2030** (USD 1 trillion in merchandise and USD 1 trillion in services).
49. The **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)** under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry serves as the nodal statutory body responsible for formulating and administering India's Foreign Trade Policy.
50. **Special Economic Zones (SEZs)**, institutionalized under the SEZ Act of 2005, operate as duty-free enclaves treated as foreign territory for trade operations, duties, and tariffs to promote export-led manufacturing and services.

Topic 10 — International Institutions, Groupings and Summits

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. The **United Nations Monetary and Financial Conference**, convened at **Bretton Woods, New Hampshire (USA) in July 1944**, established the post-war international economic order.
2. The conference created the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** and the **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)**, historically designated as the **Bretton Woods Twins**.
3. Both the **International Monetary Fund** and the **World Bank** maintain their permanent global headquarters in **Washington D.C.** (not New York City).
4. The primary mandate of the **IMF** is to oversee the international monetary system, ensure exchange rate stability, conduct economic surveillance, and provide short-to-medium-term balance of payments (BoP) financial assistance.
5. IMF financial assistance is extended **exclusively to sovereign member countries** facing balance of payments difficulties under conditional policy reform programs; it does not lend to non-members or private corporations.
6. The **World Bank Group (WBG)** is a multilateral development institution dedicated to reducing global poverty, building shared prosperity, and financing sustainable long-term economic development.
7. The World Bank Group comprises five legally distinct development institutions: **IBRD**, **IDA**, **IFC**, **MIGA**, and **ICSID**.
8. The **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)** provides sovereign loans and development financing to middle-income and creditworthy developing governments.
9. The **International Development Association (IDA)**, established in 1960, serves as the World Bank's "soft-loan window," providing interest-free credits and non-repayable grants to the world's poorest developing nations.
10. The **International Finance Corporation (IFC)**, founded in 1956, promotes economic growth by financing **private-sector investments** and mobilizing commercial capital in developing countries without requiring sovereign government guarantees.
11. The **Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA)** provides political risk insurance and credit enhancement guarantees to cross-border private investors and lenders.
12. The **International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID)** facilitates the legal conciliation and arbitration of international investment disputes between foreign investors and host sovereign states; India is **not a signatory** to the ICSID Convention.
13. **Special Drawing Rights (SDRs)** are international reserve assets created by the IMF in 1969 to supplement member countries' official foreign exchange reserves.
14. The value of the SDR is determined based on a weighted currency basket consisting of five major global currencies: the **US Dollar, Euro, Chinese Renminbi (Yuan), Japanese Yen, and British Pound Sterling**.
15. Voting power within the IMF and IBRD is linked to each member country's allocated **financial quota**, reflecting its relative size and openness in the global economy; the **United States** holds effective veto power over major charter amendments requiring an 85% supermajority.
16. The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** was established in **1966** to foster economic growth and regional cooperation in Asia and the Pacific; it is headquartered in **Mandaluyong (Metro Manila), Philippines**.
17. The **Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)** is a Beijing-headquartered multilateral development bank initiated by China, commencing operations in **January 2016**; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder after China.
18. The **New Development Bank (NDB)**, formerly known as the BRICS Development Bank, was established under the Fortaleza Declaration (2014) and operates from its global headquarters in **Shanghai, China**.
19. Unlike the quota-based voting of the IMF, the founding BRICS members originally held equal voting shares (20% each) in the New Development Bank.
20. The **Group of Twenty (G20)** was founded in **1999** following the Asian financial crisis as a forum for finance ministers and central bank governors, and upgraded to a heads-of-state leaders' summit in **2008**.

21. The G20 represents approximately 85% of global GDP, 75% of international trade, and two-thirds of the world's population.
22. Under **India's G20 Presidency in 2023**, the **African Union (AU)** was formally inducted as a permanent member; subsequent summits follow a historic Global South Troika: **19th in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil (Nov 2024)**, **20th in South Africa (2025)**, followed by the **21st in the United States (2026)**.
23. The official theme of India's 2023 G20 Presidency was drawn from the Maha Upanishad: ***Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* — "One Earth, One Family, One Future"**.
24. India's official G20 logo juxtaposed planet Earth with the national flower, the **lotus, bearing seven petals** that signify the **seven continents** and universal harmony.
25. In Uttar Pradesh, official G20 meetings during India's Presidency were organized across four historic hubs: **Varanasi, Agra, Lucknow, and Greater Noida** (excluding Kanpur).
26. The **Group of Seven (G7)** consists of advanced industrialized liberal democracies: **Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, the United Kingdom, and the United States**, alongside the European Union; recent summits include the 49th in Hiroshima, Japan (2023), 50th in Apulia, Italy (2024), and 51st in Kananaskis, Canada (2025).
27. Russia was admitted to form the G8 in 1997, but its membership was suspended indefinitely in **2014** following the annexation of Crimea, reverting the grouping to the G7.
28. The acronym **"BRIC"** was originally formulated by British economist **Jim O'Neill** in a Goldman Sachs global economics paper published in **2001**.
29. The inaugural formal BRIC Leaders' Summit took place on **16 June 2009** at **Yekaterinburg, Russia**.
30. **South Africa** was officially inducted into the grouping in **December 2010**, transforming the acronym into **BRICS** and attending its first summit at Sanya, China in 2011.
31. The landmark **10th BRICS Summit** was hosted in **Johannesburg, South Africa** in **July 2018**.
32. The BRICS institutional architecture is underpinned by two financial pillars: the **New Development Bank (NDB)** for infrastructure finance and the **Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA)** for short-term liquidity defense.
33. BRICS underwent historic membership expansion, formally admitting **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the United Arab Emirates** on 1 January 2024; the landmark **16th BRICS Summit** was convened in **Kazan, Russia (October 2024)** introducing a new "Partner Country" category (13 partner nations), with the 17th Summit hosted by **Brazil in 2025**.
34. The **Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN)** was established on **8 August 1967** via the Bangkok Declaration by Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore, and Thailand; its Central Secretariat is located in **Jakarta, Indonesia**.
35. ASEAN currently comprises **ten member nations**: Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, and Vietnam (with Timor-Leste admitted in principle).
36. India became a Sectoral Dialogue Partner of ASEAN in 1992, a Full Dialogue Partner in 1995, and formalized the **ASEAN–India Strategic Partnership** with annual bilateral summits.
37. The **South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC)** was founded on **8 December 1985** in **Dhaka, Bangladesh**, comprising eight member nations: Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka.
38. The permanent Secretariat of SAARC was established in **Kathmandu, Nepal** in January 1987.
39. The **first SAARC Summit hosted in India** took place in **Bangalore in November 1986** (the second SAARC Summit overall).
40. The **Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC)** was established on **6 June 1997** through the Bangkok Declaration.
41. BIMSTEC unites seven littoral and adjacent countries of the Bay of Bengal: **five from South Asia (Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Nepal, Sri Lanka)** and **two from Southeast Asia (Myanmar, Thailand)**.
42. **Indonesia is not a member of BIMSTEC**; it belongs to ASEAN.
43. The Permanent Secretariat of BIMSTEC was inaugurated in **Dhaka, Bangladesh** in **2014**.

44. The **5th BIMSTEC Summit**, held virtually on **30 March 2022**, was hosted and chaired by **Sri Lanka** (Colombo); the 6th Summit was convened in **Bangkok, Thailand (2024)**.
45. The **Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)** is a Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance founded in **2001** in Shanghai; its Secretariat is located in **Beijing, China**, and its Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) is based in **Tashkent, Uzbekistan**.
46. India and Pakistan became full members of the SCO at the **Astana Summit (2017)**; **Iran** joined as the 9th member in **2023** (under India's chairmanship), and **Belarus** was admitted as the **10th member** at the **Astana Summit in Kazakhstan (July 2024)**, with the 25th Summit scheduled for **China in 2025**.
47. The **Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)** is an intergovernmental economic organization of 38 market-oriented democracies headquartered at the Château de la Muette in **Paris, France**.
48. The **World Trade Organization (WTO)**, established on 1 January 1995 (Marrakesh Agreement) with 166 members, has its permanent headquarters in **Geneva, Switzerland**; its supreme governing body, the Ministerial Conference, rotates globally (e.g., MC-12 Geneva 2022, **MC-13 Abu Dhabi 2024**, and **MC-14 Yaoundé, Cameroon 2026** — the 2nd MC hosted on African soil after Nairobi 2015).
49. The **World Economic Forum (WEF)** is an independent international non-governmental organization based in **Cologny (Geneva), Switzerland**, renowned for convening the annual global business and political summit at **Davos**.
50. Major international flagship reports and their publishing bodies include:
    - **World Economic Outlook (WEO)** & **Global Financial Stability Report** → Published by the **IMF**.
    - **World Development Report (WDR)** & **Global Economic Prospects** → Published by the **World Bank**.
    - **Global Competitiveness Report (GCR)** & **Global Risks Report** → Published by the **World Economic Forum (WEF)**.
    - **Human Development Report (HDR)** → Published by the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)**.

Topic 11 — Services, Cooperatives, Companies and Regulators

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. The **tertiary sector (services sector)** encompasses intangible economic activities including wholesale and retail trade, hotels and restaurants, transport, storage, communication, banking, insurance, real estate, professional services, public administration, education, and healthcare.
2. In macroeconomic three-sector classification: **Primary** exploits natural resources directly (agriculture, forestry, fishing, mining, quarrying); **Secondary** processes raw materials into manufactured goods; **Tertiary** supplies commercial and personal services.
3. **Forestry, logging, and fishing**, alongside **mining and quarrying**, belong strictly to the **Primary sector**, not the tertiary sector.
4. **Marketing**, transportation, advertising, and commercial merchandising are tertiary activities; **spinning and weaving textile cloth** is a secondary manufacturing activity; **dairy cattle farming** is a primary activity.
5. The **storage and warehousing of agricultural produce** is classified as a **tertiary sector activity** (logistics and trade), rather than a secondary industrial activity.
6. In India's structural development path, the economy skipped the classic manufacturing-intensive phase, transitioning directly from an agrarian economy to a **services-dominated output structure**.
7. The relative contribution of sectors to India's Gross Value Added (GVA) at current prices ranks: **Services (~54%) > Industry (~28%) > Agriculture & Allied (~18%)**.
8. Within the services sector, the sub-category of **financial, real estate, and professional services** constitutes the largest single component (contributing over 26% of total national GVA), followed by trade, hotels, transport, and communications.
9. In national income accounting, **construction** is categorized under **Industry (Secondary sector)**, alongside manufacturing, mining, and electricity; it is not counted within the tertiary sector.
10. Under Clark-Fisher structural change theory, as per capita income rises and an economy modernizes, the **proportionate share of the tertiary sector in national income expands steadily**.
11. India's service sector is a crucial foreign exchange earner, driven by software services (IT-BPM), business process management, global capability centres (GCCs), and international tourism.
12. The **IT-BPM sector** is India's flagship tradable service export, concentrated across major technological hubs such as Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai, and the National Capital Region.
13. **Tourism and hospitality** serve as vital labor-intensive service industries, generating substantial multiplier effects across transport, handicrafts, and cultural preservation.
14. **Logistics and freight transportation** (rail, highway, civil aviation, coastal shipping, and inland waterways) represent critical backbone tertiary infrastructure, accelerated through PM Gati Shakti.
15. **Education and healthcare** constitute essential social services that directly generate human capital formation, combining public universal provisioning with private delivery.
16. The expansion of **e-commerce, digital payments, and fintech platforms** has fundamentally transformed retail trade, regulated concurrently under consumer protection, competition, and IT laws.
17. Banking and insurance constitute core **financial intermediation services**, mobilizing domestic household savings into long-term industrial and infrastructure capital.
18. A **cooperative society** is a voluntary association of individuals united democratically to satisfy their shared economic, cultural, and social needs through a jointly owned enterprise.
19. Constitutional standing: **Article 43B** of the Directive Principles of State Policy directs the State to promote voluntary formation, autonomous functioning, democratic control, and professional management of cooperative societies.
20. The **97th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2011** accorded constitutional protection to cooperatives by inserting Article 19(1)(c) (right to form cooperative societies), Article 43B, and Part IXB (The Co-operative Societies).

21. The Union **Ministry of Cooperation** was established in **July 2021** to provide a dedicated institutional and legal architecture for realizing the vision of *Sahakar se Samriddhi*.
22. Diverse cooperative structures operate in India: Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS), District Central Cooperative Banks (DCCBs), marketing cooperatives, and dairy federations.
23. Urban cooperative banks and multi-state cooperative banks are brought under the direct regulatory and supervisory purview of the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** to protect depositor savings.
24. The **Amul model** (Kaira District Co-operative Milk Producers' Union) established the foundation for India's **Operation Flood (White Revolution)**, orchestrated through the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) under Dr. Verghese Kurien.
25. Under Indian jurisprudence, an incorporated **company** is an artificial legal person possessing perpetual succession, a common seal, and a distinct corporate entity separate from its shareholders.
26. The **Companies Act, 2013** represents the principal statutory framework governing the incorporation, corporate governance, auditing, and dissolution of corporate entities in India.
27. **Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013** mandates that every qualifying company must allocate at least **2% of the average net profits made during the three immediately preceding financial years** toward Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR).
28. A company is legally obligated to comply with CSR provisions if it satisfies any of three financial criteria during the immediately preceding financial year:
    - Net worth of **₹500 crore or more**, or
    - Turnover of **₹1,000 crore or more**, or
    - Net profit of **₹5 crore or more**. 29. The administrative machinery and operational procedures for corporate philanthropy are delineated in the **Companies (Corporate Social Responsibility Policy) Rules, 2014**. 30. CSR expenditures must be directed exclusively toward activities listed in **Schedule VII** of the Companies Act, 2013, including poverty eradication, preventive healthcare, education, gender equality, environmental sustainability, and rural sports. 31. Company expenditures that benefit **exclusively the company's own employees and their families** are expressly disqualified from counting toward mandatory CSR obligations. 32. India holds the distinction of being the **first country in the world** to mandate corporate social responsibility by statutory legislation (operational from 1 April 2014). 33. Qualifying companies are required to constitute a **CSR Committee of the Board of Directors**, comprising three or more directors, including at least one independent director. 34. The **Uday Kotak Committee on Corporate Governance (SEBI, 2017)** recommended the progressive separation of the roles of Chairman of the Board and Managing Director/CEO, advocating that listed companies have a non-executive Chairperson. 35. The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, established under the RBI Act, 1934, acts as the central monetary authority and prudential regulator of commercial and cooperative banking institutions. 36. The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)**, established in 1988 and given statutory autonomy under the SEBI Act, 1992, regulates capital markets, stock exchanges, mutual funds, and investor protection. 37. The **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** is a statutory body established under the IRDA Act, 1999, headquartered in **Hyderabad, Telangana**. 38. The **Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)** was established under the PFRDA Act, 2013, to regulate the National Pension System (NPS) and the broader pension sector. 39. The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**, established under the Competition Act, 2002, is tasked with preventing anti-competitive agreements, prohibiting abuse of dominant position, and regulating corporate combinations (mergers and acquisitions). 40. The **Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)** was established on **20 February 1997** under the TRAI Act, 1997, to regulate telecommunication tariffs and interconnection; appellate jurisdiction is vested in the **Telecom Disputes Settlement and Appellate Tribunal (TDSAT)**. 41. The **Universal Service Obligation Fund (USOF)**, statutory under the Indian Telegraph (Amendment) Act, 2003 (now the Telecommunications Act, 2023 / Digital Bharat Nidhi), subsidizes telecom connectivity and broadband infrastructure across rural and remote regions. 42. **Project Arrow**, initiated by the Department of Posts in **April 2008**, is a national modernization initiative aimed at transforming traditional **post offices** through computerized operations, improved core banking, and citizen-

friendly service delivery. 43. The **International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA)**, headquartered at GIFT City, Gandhinagar, serves as the unified statutory regulator for financial products, financial services, and institutions located in International Financial Services Centres (IFSCs). 44. The **Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS)** is the National Standards Body of India established under the BIS Act, 2016, administering quality marks such as the **ISI mark** for industrial goods and **Hallmarking** for gold jewelry. 45. The **Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)** is an autonomous statutory body established under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006, within the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, regulating food manufacturing, storage, and hygiene standards. 46. **ECOMARC** is India's national eco-label scheme launched in 1991, administered by BIS in coordination with the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change; it awards an **earthen pot logo** to consumer goods that meet stringent environmental standards alongside quality parameters. 47. **AGMARK** is a certification mark for agricultural produce under the Agricultural Produce (Grading and Marking) Act, 1937, administered by the Directorate of Marketing and Inspection (DMI) under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. 48. Under the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, the **Maximum Retail Price (MRP)** represents the statutory upper bound inclusive of all taxes; retailers may lawfully sell or discount **below the MRP**, but charging any amount above the printed MRP is a punishable offense. 49. The **Consumer Protection Act, 2019** repealed the older 1986 statute, establishing the **Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA)** to protect consumer rights against false advertising, unfair trade practices, and defective goods, introducing statutory product liability. 50. Consumer dispute redressal operates through a three-tier quasi-judicial forum structure: District Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions, State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions, and the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (NCDRC).

Topic 12 — Economic Laws, Reports, Rankings and Misc

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. The **Economic Survey** is prepared under the guidance of the Chief Economic Adviser (CEA) in the Department of Economic Affairs and presented to Parliament by the Finance Minister, traditionally one day prior to the presentation of the Union Budget.
2. The Economic Survey serves as an authoritative retrospective review of macroeconomic performance, sectoral trends, structural challenges, and policy trajectories.
3. In response to global geopolitical supply shocks, the **Economic Survey 2022–23** highlighted that the central government provided supply-side relief by **reducing excise duties on fuel and import duties on key inputs**.
4. The **Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), 2016** established a consolidated, time-bound legal framework for the insolvency resolution of corporate debtors, partnerships, and individuals, administered by the **Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)**.
5. Under the IBC, the **Committee of Creditors (CoC)**, comprising financial creditors, holds decision-making authority over the approval of corporate insolvency resolution plans.
6. The **Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA), 2016** established State-level Real Estate Regulatory Authorities to enforce project registration, mandate escrow accounts for homebuyer deposits (at least 70%), and protect consumer interests.
7. The **Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002** was enacted to prevent money laundering and confiscate property derived from proceeds of scheduled criminal offenses.
8. Under the PMLA, the **Director of the Directorate of Enforcement (ED)** is legally empowered to call for records, audit trails, and financial statements maintained by reporting entities and financial institutions.
9. Four comprehensive **Labour Codes** were enacted by Parliament in 2019–20 to rationalize 29 central labour laws: the **Code on Wages (2019)**, **Industrial Relations Code (2020)**, **Code on Social Security (2020)**, and **Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code (2020)**.
10. The **Code on Wages, 2019** consolidated four legacy statutes: the Payment of Wages Act (1936), the Minimum Wages Act (1948), the Payment of Bonus Act (1965), and the Equal Remuneration Act (1976).
11. Historical chronology of economic legislation: **Minimum Wages Act (1948) → Industries (Development and Regulation) Act (1951) → MRTP Act (1969) → FERA (1973) → SEBI Act (1992) → FEMA (1999) → Competition Act (2002) → Companies Act (2013) → IBC (2016)**.
12. The **Labour Bureau**, an attached office of the Ministry of Labour and Employment, is responsible for compiling and publishing statistics on industrial disputes, strikes, lockouts, lay-offs, and retrenchments.
13. The **Human Development Index (HDI)** is published annually by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) in its Human Development Report, initiated in **1990** under Mahbub ul Haq and Amartya Sen.
14. In ranking metrics, an **increasing numerical rank** (e.g., from 130 to 132) indicates a relative **deterioration or slip** in international performance, not an improvement or upgrade.
15. In the **Human Development Report 2021–22**, India's HDI score stood at 0.633, causing its global rank to slip to **132nd** among 191 nations.
16. In the **Human Development Report 2020**, India was ranked **131st** globally (HDI value 0.645).
17. The **Gender Inequality Index (GII)** was officially introduced in the **2010 Human Development Report**, measuring gender disparities across reproductive health, empowerment, and economic activity.
18. The **Physical Quality of Life Index (PQLI)** was formulated by **Morris D. Morris** in 1979 as an unweighted average of three non-monetary indicators: basic literacy, infant mortality rate, and life expectancy at age one.
19. The **Global Hunger Index (GHI)** is designed to comprehensively measure and track hunger globally, calculating composite scores across four indicators: undernourishment, child stunting, child wasting, and child mortality.
20. In the **Global Hunger Index 2017**, India was placed at the **100th position** among 119 evaluated countries.

21. The **World Happiness Report** is released annually by the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN), ranking national happiness based on subjective life evaluations from the Gallup World Poll.
22. In the **World Happiness Report 2022**, India was ranked **136th** globally.
23. The **Global Peace Index (GPI)** is produced annually by the **Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)**, measuring the state of peace across 163 independent states and territories.
24. In the **Global Peace Index 2018**, India was ranked **136th** worldwide.
25. In the World Bank's historical **Ease of Doing Business** assessments, India achieved rapid regulatory improvements, leaping to **77th in Doing Business 2019** and **63rd in Doing Business 2020**.
26. Following data irregularity investigations, the World Bank permanently **discontinued the Doing Business report** in September 2021, replacing it with the new Business Ready (B-READY) framework.
27. The **Global Competitiveness Report (GCR)** is published annually by the **World Economic Forum (WEF)**, evaluating national productivity and competitiveness across institutions, infrastructure, and human capital.
28. The **Global Innovation Index (GII)** is published by the **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)** in partnership with Cornell University and INSEAD.
29. **NITI Aayog** serves as the **nodal institutional body** responsible for coordinating, overseeing, and monitoring the localization of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) across Indian States and Union Territories.
30. The **SDG India Index**, developed by NITI Aayog, tracks progress across all States and UTs, classifying entities into four performance categories based on composite scores:
    - **Aspirant:** Score 0–49
    - **Performer:** Score 50–64
    - **Front-runner:** Score 65–99
    - **Achiever:** Score 100 31. India's national composite SDG score has exhibited sustained progress: **57 in 2018 → 60 in 2019–20 → 66 in 2020–21 → 71 in 2023–24**. 32. In the **SDG India Index 2023–24** (4th edition), **Kerala and Uttarakhand emerged as joint top-performing States** with a composite score of **79**, followed by Tamil Nadu (78); **Bihar** recorded the lowest composite score (57). 33. **Uttar Pradesh** progressed from the **Performer** category (score 55 in 2019–20 and 60 in 2020–21) to the **Front-runner** category with a score of **67 in 2023–24**. 34. In the global **Sustainable Development Report (SDSN)**, India's international ranking evolved over time: **110th in 2016, 116th in 2017, 112th in 2023, 109th in 2024, and 99th in 2025** (entering the top 100 for the first time). 35. Mapping of high-yield Sustainable Development Goals:
    - **SDG 1:** No Poverty
    - **SDG 2:** Zero Hunger
    - **SDG 3:** Good Health and Well-being
    - **SDG 4:** Quality Education
    - **SDG 6:** Clean Water and Sanitation
    - **SDG 7:** Affordable and Clean Energy
    - **SDG 13:** Climate Action
    - **SDG 14:** Life Below Water
    - **SDG 15:** Life on Land 36. In the **SDG Urban Index 2021–22** released by NITI Aayog, the top three ranked urban areas were **Shimla (1st)**, **Coimbatore (2nd)**, and **Chandigarh (3rd)**. 37. Because India accounts for approximately **one-sixth of the global population**, achieving the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development globally is structurally contingent upon India's domestic development outcomes. 38. The UN Secretary-General submits an **Annual SDG Progress Report**, while the comprehensive **Global Sustainable Development Report (GSDR)** is produced by an independent panel of scientists **once every four years (quadrennial)**. 39. Scottish philosopher **Adam Smith** is celebrated as the **"Father of Modern Economics"** for his foundational work *An Inquiry into the Nature and Causes of the Wealth of Nations* (1776). 40. British economist **John Maynard Keynes** pioneered modern **macroeconomics** through his seminal treatise *The General Theory of Employment, Interest and Money* (1936), advocating government intervention during

demand crises. 41. **Frederick Winslow Taylor** is recognized as the "Father of Scientific Management" for introducing time-and-motion studies and standardized industrial labor processes. 42. Nobel laureate **Amartya Sen** coined the demographic concept of **"missing women"** (1990) to quantify the millions of females missing from the population in South and East Asia due to sex-selective abortion, female infanticide, and unequal healthcare access. 43. Sociologist **Robert E. Park** introduced the concept of the **"Marginal Man"** (1928), analyzing individuals living on the cultural boundaries of two distinct social groups. 44. Canadian media theorist **Marshall McLuhan** coined the term **"Global Village"**, conceptualizing how electronic telecommunications contract the globe into a single interconnected community. 45. Key economic treatises and their authors:

- *Wealth of Nations* (1776) → **Adam Smith**
- *Principles of Political Economy and Taxation* (1817) → **David Ricardo**
- *Das Kapital* (1867) → **Karl Marx**
- *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (1901) → **Dadabhai Naoroji**
- *The General Theory* (1936) → **John Maynard Keynes**
- *Asian Drama: An Inquiry into the Poverty of Nations* (1968) → **Gunnar Myrdal** 46. The **Perform, Achieve and Trade (PAT)** scheme, operationalized in **2012** under the National Mission for Enhanced Energy Efficiency (NMEEE) by the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE), is a market-based mechanism to reduce specific energy consumption in energy-intensive designated industrial consumers. 47. The **MISHTI (Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Incomes)** scheme was announced in the Union Budget 2023–24 and launched on World Environment Day (5 June 2023) to facilitate mangrove afforestation along India's coastline and salt-pan lands. 48. **Mission LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment)** was unveiled by Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the **COP26 World Leaders' Summit in Glasgow (November 2021)** as an international mass movement promoting mindful and deliberate resource utilization. 49. The **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)** was launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in **January 2019** as a targeted national framework to reduce particulate matter (PM2.5 and PM10) concentrations by 20–30% across designated non-attainment cities. 50. The **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**, approved by the Union Cabinet on **29 July 2020**, was drafted by a committee chaired by former ISRO chief **Dr. K. Kasturirangan**, replacing the previous National Policy on Education of **1986** (after an interval of 34 years) and introducing a USD 5+3+3+4USD pedagogical structure with vocational education starting from **Grade 6**.